



Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects

D2.TGA.CL6.03

D2.TRM.CL9.10

Trainee Manual



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Specialist centre
for foods, tourism
& hospitality



William
Angliss
Institute

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for foods, tourism
& hospitality

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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees' chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service

- Front Office
- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects in a range of settings within the travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D2.TGA.CL6.03

D2.TRM.CL9.10

Nominal Hours:

60

Element 1: Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Confirm the program/project
- 1.2 Identify factors affecting timelines for implementation
- 1.3 Develop program/project plans
- 1.4 Link budget to key outcomes
- 1.5 Identify monitoring and reporting arrangements
- 1.6 Allocate resources
- 1.7 Integrate program/plan with other initiatives
- 1.8 Confirm agreements with service providers
- 1.9 Develop contingency plans
- 1.10 Develop teams to support program/project implementation
- 1.11 Select program/project management tools

Element 2: Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Allocate tasks and resources
- 2.2 Maintain financial control systems
- 2.3 Monitor program/project progress
- 2.4 Report program/project progress
- 2.5 Maintain program/project records
- 2.6 Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation

Element 3: Finalise the innovative tourism program/project

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Administer winding up activities for the program/project
- 3.2 Review program/project administration
- 3.3 Evaluate the program/project
- 3.4 Report on program/project administration and results

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project				
1.1	Confirm the program/project	1.1	1,2	1
1.2	Identify factors affecting timelines for implementation	1.2	3,4	2
1.3	Develop program/project plans	1.3	5,6	3
1.4	Link budget to key outcomes	1.4	7,8	4
1.5	Identify monitoring and reporting arrangements	1.5	9,10	5
1.6	Allocate resources	1.6	11,12	6
1.7	Integrate program/plan with other initiatives	1.7	13,14	7
1.8	Confirm agreements with service providers	1.8	15,	8
1.9	Develop contingency plans	1.9	16	9
1.10	Develop teams to support program/project implementation	1.10	17,18	10
1.11	Select program/project management tools	1.11	19	11
Element 2: Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project				
2.1	Allocate tasks and resources	2.1	20,21	12
2.2	Maintain financial control systems	2.2	22	13
2.3	Monitor program/project progress	2.3	23	14
2.4	Report program/project progress	2.4	24	15
2.5	Maintain program/project records	2.5	25	16
2.6	Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation	2.6	26	17

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 3: Finalise the innovative tourism program/project				
3.1	Administer winding up activities for the program/project	3.1	27	18
3.2	Review program/project administration	3.2	28	19
3.3	Evaluate the program/project	3.3	29	20
3.4	Report on program/project administration and results	3.4	30	21

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Audit	An official inspection of an individual's or organisation's accounts, typically by an independent body
Budget	A quantitative expression of a plan for a defined period of time. It may include planned sales volumes and revenues, resource quantities, costs and expenses, assets, liabilities and cash flows. It expresses strategic plans of business units, organisations, activities or events in measurable terms
Capital expenditure	An amount spent to acquire or improve a long-term asset such as equipment or buildings
Community	A social group of any size whose members reside in a specific locality, share government, and often have a common cultural and historical heritage
Conservation	The act of preserving, guarding, or protecting; wise use of biodiversity, environment, and natural resources, including protection and management
Consequences	Result or effect of an action or condition
Contingency Plan	Plan designed to take a possible future event or circumstance into account
Critical Path Method	One of several related techniques for doing project planning. CPM is for projects that are made up of a number of individual "activities." If some of the activities require other activities to finish before they can start, then the project becomes a complex web of activities
Discretionary income	The amount of an individual's income that is left for spending, investing or saving after taxes and personal necessities (such as food, shelter, and clothing) have been paid
Eco-tourism	Tourism directed toward exotic, often threatened, natural environments, especially to support conservation efforts and observe wildlife
Embezzlement	Theft or misappropriation of funds placed in one's trust or belonging to one's employer
Evaluation	The making of a judgment about the amount, number, or value of something; assessment

Term	Explanation
Feasibility	The state or degree of being easily or conveniently done
Fraud	Deliberate deception to secure unfair or unlawful gain
Gantt Chart	Type of bar chart that illustrates a project schedule. Gantt charts illustrate the start and finish dates of the terminal elements and summary elements of a project
OSH	Occupational safety and health
Inflation	A sustained increase in the general price level of goods and services in an economy over a period of time
infrastructure	The basic physical and organisational structures and facilities (e.g., buildings, roads, and power supplies) needed for the operation of a society or enterprise
Innovative	Featuring new methods; advanced and original. "innovative designs"
Intangible resource	An asset that is not physical in nature
Inventory	A complete list of items such as property, goods in stock, or the contents of a building
Milestone	A significant event or stage in the life, progress, development of a project
Mission Statement	A statement of the purpose of a company, organisation or person
Monitor	An instrument or device used for observing, checking, or keeping a continuous record of a process or quantity
KPI	Key performance indicator is a business metric used to evaluate factors that are crucial to the success of an organisation
Objective	A thing aimed at or sought; a goal
PERT	Program Evaluation and Review Technique
Program	A planned series of future events, activities, items, or performances'
Project	'An individual or collaborative enterprise that is carefully planned and designed to achieve a particular aim'

Term	Explanation
Remedial	Giving or intended as a remedy or cure
Resources	A stock or supply of money, materials, staff, and other assets that can be drawn on by a person or organisation in order to function effectively
Revenue	The income that a company receives from its normal business activities
Social media	Computer-mediated tools that allow people to create, share or exchange information, ideas, and pictures/videos in virtual communities
Sustainability	The capacity to endure; it is how biological systems remain diverse and productive indefinitely
Vision Statement	A declaration of an organisation's objectives, ideally based on economic foresight, intended to guide its internal decision-making

Element 1:

Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project

1.1 Confirm the program/project

Introduction

Most tourism operations will be required to sell tourism products and services to customers.

Some of these products and services may come in the form of established offerings, either provided by separate organisations or created by travel organisations themselves, often in the form of tours or specialised events and activities.

In this manual we will look at a different offering that may be provided by a tourism organisation. That being specialised programs or projects.

But what is a project or program?

Definition of terms innovative, project and program

Before we look at the planning of innovative projects and programs it is important to understand what these three terms mean.

The term innovative is defined as:

- (Of a product, idea, etc.) Featuring new methods; advanced and original. "innovative designs"
- (Of a person) introducing new ideas; original and creative in thinking.

The term project is defined as 'an individual or collaborative enterprise that is carefully planned and designed to achieve a particular aim'.

The term program is defined as 'a planned series of future events, activities, items, or performances'.

The source of these definitions is dictionary.reference.com.



Aspects of project or program to confirm

When deciding to undertake an innovative project or program there are a few aspects that need to be confirmed before the finer details of the actual project or program can be planned.

The aspects of a project or program to clarify include:

- Type of program
- Objectives
- Key initiatives.

In this section we will explain these three aspects in more detail.

Identify types of tourism project or program

As can be seen in these definitions an innovative project or program can be far reaching covering a wide range of aims and activities.

Whilst the list of potential tourism related innovative projects and programs are endless possible initiatives may be focused on the development and growth of tourism including, but not limited to:

- Development of towns, locations and attractions to support tourism
- Development of tourism infrastructure - including transportation, roads, airports, electricity, water etc.
- Creating new tourism-related businesses - including accommodation, shops, entertainment
- Development of tourism related education and training
- Developing tourism infrastructure
- Promoting tourism for the country or region
- Preserving, rehabilitating or expanding tourism attractions
- Development of eco-tourism initiatives
- Conservation of local community wildlife
- Development of local conservation projects
- Development of sustainability projects and programs
- Developing tourism policies and procedures
- Developing tourism activities and events
- Conducting tourism research projects
- Conducting environmental assessments
- Developing local communities
- Developing awareness of local community issues
- Conduct fundraising campaigns.





Activity 1 – Research tourism projects and programs

You are asked to conduct research internet to identify the current tourism projects and programs being conducted in any corner of the world.

Please identify three different tourism projects and programs, conducted in three different countries which does NOT include y our own country, ideally in different continents.

You are required to identify the:

- Country / location of the project or program
- Type of project or program
- Objectives of the project
- Key initiatives or activities of the project or program.



PROJECT / PROGRAM 1

Country / location of the project or program	
Type of project or program	
Objectives of the project	
Key initiatives or activities of the project or program	

PROJECT / PROGRAM 2

Country / location of the project or program	
Type of project or program	
Objectives of the project	
Key initiatives or activities of the project or program	

PROJECT / PROGRAM 3

Country / location of the project or program	
Type of project or program	
Objectives of the project	
Key initiatives or activities of the project or program	

Identify reasons for possible tourism projects or programs

In most cases, the need for tourism projects or programs results from some identified issue that must be addressed to help promote, grow or impact positively on the tourism industry.

Some of these reasons may include:

- Changes in customer expectations
- Substandard products – products may be out-dated, inferior or in need of replacement or renovation
- Marketing – the wrong message is being delivered to target audiences giving them unrealistic expectations
- Opportunity / commercial potential
- Changes in local and global economic conditions
- Strategic directions of local communities or individual tourism organisation
- Inability to service current demand - not enough accommodation for visitors demand
- Inappropriate operating practices for the current market place and visitors - lack of official training and qualification for tourism guides in regards to 'high risk activities' such as diving
- Visitor expectation levels below acceptable levels
- Visible destruction of local environment and habitat resulting from tourism operations
- Increase in conflict within local community resulting from increased tourism activity
- Lack of resources for service delivery
 - Human - not enough trained staff members in view of a coastal resort opening
 - Physical - poor road infrastructure to service the number of visitors forecasted for a new coastal resort
 - Financial - lack of available local funding resulting in having to put in place strategies to research and obtain grants, sponsorship, partnerships
 - Existing potential not being exploited.



Methods to identify and clarify possible objectives

Techniques which have proved to be effective in identifying current issues and possible objectives for possible tourism projects or programs include:

Talking to local business owners and senior management

To:

- Obtain their thoughts, wishes, ideas, considerations and preferences in relation to tourism and future directions
- Gain the benefit of their experience and knowledge in this field
- Initiate and develop a good rapport which can be leveraged into an effective and ongoing mutually rewarding relationship
- Reading internal documentation which contains details of the directions and operations of the proposing business such as:
 - Strategic plans
 - Business plans
 - Operational plans
 - Annual reports.



Identifying the specific tourism goals and objectives of local communities

As specified by:

- Community groups
- Interested parties
- Other businesses
- Government agencies, especially tourism authorities
- Peak industry groups representing tourism operators.

Speaking to a broad cross-section of those affected by tourism within the local community

Such as:

- Employers outside the direct tourism industry
- The unemployed
- Families and households
- Police and emergency services
- Social welfare and child protection agencies
- Training and recruitment organisations
- Officials from government agencies dealing with immigration, customs, health, foreign affairs and trade and other similar offices.



Understanding the changes in demand for local services and facilities

Through:

- Talking to business owners
- Liaising with officials who provide government-delivered services
- Discussing availability and supply of services and demand on same with representatives of the general community
- Reading plans for the development or ongoing provision of related services to the geographic areas under consideration
- Using market research information to predict estimated demand based on data collected.



Establish project or program objectives

One of the initial aspects in planning innovative tourism projects or programs is to identify objectives you wish to achieve.

The objectives are the goals or targets to work towards and once defined, enable the planning of projects or programs to achieve them.

It is preferable to have realistic objectives, which are later broken down into manageable targets. They need to be consistent, follow through and relate to each other.

The objectives which will be set for individual projects or programs will be decided on the basis of a combination of factors.

In general the factors which will be influential are:

- Results of consultations with the community
- Input made by relevant stakeholder groups
- Identified opportunities and threats as revealed by the research which has been undertaken
- Government policies, initiatives and over-arching plans and strategies
- Economic imperatives
- Local government or in-country plans
- Need to care for the local environment
- Action being taken in relation to tourism activities/initiatives by other similar communities and/or nearby areas.



Types of objectives of tourism projects or programs

The types of objectives are endless however can include, but not limited to:

- Inform the target audiences or communities about tourism
- Create a more positive community orientation and attitude towards tourism
- Identify and exploit natural and created attractions as attractive and viable tourism destinations and activities
- Develop specific attractions to grow the local tourism industry
- Achieve a win-win outcome where the tourists benefits from the experience and the community also reaps advantages in terms of jobs and income
- Identify, address and resolve problems and issues associated with tourism in the host communities – so harm or adverse outcomes to the community are minimised or eliminated
- Generate reasons for people to visit the target destinations – in terms of tourist benefits, financial incentives or personal experiences.



Activity 2 – Identify your own innovative tourism project or program

Based on the research conducted in Activity 1, you now have an understanding of the different types of innovative tourism projects and programs currently being conducted.

For the purpose of this manual, you are to identify a possible innovative tourism project or program that you could conduct, **FOR YOUR LOCAL AREA.**

It is important to note, that the types of project or program you choose in this Activity, will be used for all activities in this manual.

You are required to identify the:

- Location of the project or program
- Type of project or program
- Objectives of the project
- Key initiatives or activities of the project or program
- Explain why it is considered 'innovative'.



YOUR INNOVATIVE PROJECT / PROGRAM

Location of the project or program	
Type of project or program	
Objectives of the project	
Key initiatives or activities of the project or program	
Explanation why it is innovative.	



1.2 Identify factors affecting timelines for implementation

Introduction

There are many factors that may affect the planning, implementation and timelines for the introduction of various tourism projects and plans.

The larger the scale of the project, the need to consult and rely on local governments and other external influences will become greater.

In this section we will explore the different factors that will impact on the implementation of tourism projects and programs.



Economic factors

There is no doubt the state of the economy is extremely influential on trade and we have to take into account the emerging economic climate.

This is especially true where funding for projects may be sourced by local governments or where new innovative initiatives are driven by expected revenues and demand.

There are economic cycles that need to be taken into account in your planning of projects and programs.

They are periodic fluctuations that occur quite regularly, driving the general level of economic activity upwards (inflationary) or downwards (recessionary).

The economic factors that may impact on innovative tourism projects and programs may include:

- The local economic environment as well as the economic state of other countries from which the business draws its customers
- Inflation
- Interest rates
- Exchange rates
- Levels of employment and unemployment
- Availability of local competent staff
- Amount of discretionary income customers have
- Community thoughts on the state or future of the economy
- State of relevant economies
- Current spending patterns.



- Changing cost of travel – which may:
 - Decrease as budget carriers emerge to cater for routes to proposed communities – meaning a potential for increased visits to the community
 - Decrease as the number of tourists rise based on economies of scale and associated factors
 - Rise where demand increases based on the basic economic law of supply and demand – potentially lowering visits
 - Rise where certain exclusive or expensive types of transportation need to be used to access locations
- Changing marketplace activities – undertaken by other business sectors and industries, such as:
 - Other organisations opening-up and developing additional attractions – which give potential visitors more reason to visit
 - Venues opening-up new accommodation, food or other support businesses – giving visitors more choice and increasing the chance of visits
 - Businesses being prepared to offer deals, packages and specials – which lower the cost of visits and increase the value-for-money of the tourism experience in that destination.



Environmental factors

Where innovative tourism projects and programs are based around eco-tourism and sustainability initiatives, environmental factors will certainly drive its planning and implementation.

Most businesses today will not only take into account not the financial goals of the organisation but also environmental responsibilities too.

Therefore possible environmental factors may include:

- Eco-tourism issues
- Sustainability issues
- Eco-friendly practices, equipment and systems
- Use of power and water
- Possible impact and 'footprint' on the environment
- Rubbish disposal
- Pollution – traffic, noise, air, water
- The impact of the venue on local communities
- Changing local environmental conditions – where:
 - Adverse environmental conditions will reduce visitations
 - Pristine conditions are sought after.



Technological factors

Technological development has played a key role in the structural changes in the service sector, especially tourism.

Boundaries between transportation, communication, travel-service and hospitality industries are disappearing as companies begin to provide direct reservations, tours, conferences, car and accommodation arrangements and electronic retailing package delivery services in competition-and-coalition with thousands of other service units.

Many customers are looking for seamless service – a one-stop shop for all their travel needs, and technology is providing the means for this to be done.

It is therefore essential that technology will play a big role in the implementation of innovative tourism projects and programs, especially when they are focused on growth and greater awareness of regions and issues.



More and more people are using the 'Net to access information in relations to tourism issues, locations, products and services.

Analysis of technological factors should include:

- Does the current technology being used effective and efficient?
- Is there new technology in the marketplace which should be used to improve business performance or save time or money?
- Provide better and different facilities for customers and perhaps give the venue a USP or meet identified customer demand and meet competition?
- Does legislation require use of nominated technology? When?
- What is the cost of new technology and what are supply or purchase options?
- Dangers or problems inherent in adopting new technology or integrating it into existing systems or processes
- How can technology help in achieving my project aims?

Political factors

In most cases, where projects are on a grand scale, understanding of political influences is essential.

Analysis of political factors should include:

- Changing political situations – locally and elsewhere which may impact:
 - Perceptions and fears about travel safety – increased fears about problems in the political system of a host community will always result in a negative impact on inbound tourism
 - Ability to move between countries and destinations – issues between governments may result in actual or perceived travel problems for tourists in terms of matters such as visas, customs, immigration, passport control
- The political stability of the country

- Is a change of government imminent and if so what implications can be expected?
- Feelings in relation to international trade and dealings
- Political relationships between home country and those countries with whom you do a lot of business
- The support available from government agencies and bodies for industry training or initiatives
- Changing government direction in relation to tourism – which may relate to:
 - Increasing investment in promoting the community – which makes more potential tourists aware of the community and what it has to offer. The government may also choose to withdraw funds from tourism marketing campaigns
 - Easing restrictions towards inbound tourists – sending a message to international visitors the government is more friendly and better disposed to overseas tourists
- Fiscal Policies
- Monetary
- Wages
- Exchange rates
- Legislative changes.



Social factors

There are many social factors that influence innovative tourism projects and programs. In fact, these factors may be the driving force for the projects and programs in the first place.

Analysis of social factors should include:

- Changing expectations of visitors – as these are impacted by:
 - Changes in the target markets for each destination or community – different target markets will have different preferences for what they want to see and do. This can be either an opportunity or a threat depending on exactly what 'it' is
 - Differing experiential profiles of new or different target markets. Most tourists will seek a new experience so the community needs to be able to provide this or at least be able to deliver some 'variation on a theme'
 - Emerging needs, wants and preferences of visitors. All emerging needs generate opportunities. These may, or may not, also be at the expense of other existing products, services and experiences
 - Their previous experiences of other communities and destinations – communities need to:
 - Provide a point of distinction between themselves and other destinations in terms of what they offer
 - Supply a certain minimum level of quality and service, and a certain basic range of products and services
- Statistics and trends in relation to demographic characteristics of markets



- What image does the industry have in the eyes of society? Is it a positive image? Is it tarnished for some reason and if so how and why?
- Projected responses of local and other communities if the business or location pursues various options - such as entering into a relationship with a certain organisation, entering into a new market, erecting a new building
- The status of the industry or business in the eyes of the community as a 'corporate citizen'
- Mobility of people and their ability to travel to and from the venue.

Legal factors

When developing projects and program, it is important to understand the different types of laws that govern prospective activities.

Laws are legally binding requirements established under legislation or Acts.

In addition to laws, there are many other 'rules' or 'conditions' set down by governments, local councils and industry authorities which not be legal, but advise you to adhere to in addition to legislative requirements.

There are many, many pieces of legislation, licences, permits, fees etc. that will apply to travel and tourism businesses. They will differ from country to country and to different types of tourism and travel related businesses.

In addition, legislation, licences and fees etc. are always subject to change over time so it is essential you develop knowledge of where to go to obtain current information and who to speak to.

Analysis of legal factors should include the laws and regulations the business must comply with as well as any new laws being proposed and how these may impact the business.

You may consider the following:

- Changes to legislation and regulations that have impacted, or have the potential to impact on projects and programs
- Industry codes of practice
- Consumer expectations
- Social responsibilities.

Types of laws and regulations

Following is a list of various laws and regulations that impact the travel and tourism industry.

Act of Parliament

An Act of Parliament is a statute enacted as primary legislation by a national or sub-national parliament.



Regulations

Principle or rule, with or without the coercive power of law, employed in controlling, directing, or managing an activity, organisation, or system

Regulations are enforced usually by a regulatory agency formed or mandated to carry out the purpose or provisions of legislation. Also called regulatory requirement

Codes of Practice

Where codes of practice are established under legislation, these have legal weight.

Compliance codes support and supplement the intent of legislation. They provide advice, information and direction on how businesses can achieve compliance with the legislation.

Compliance with these codes is not mandatory. You may elect to comply with your obligations in other ways other than as set out in the codes, however in practical terms, compliance with codes equates to compliance with the Act or the regulations.

If a venue breaches these codes, they cannot be penalised at law. It is up to the industry bodies to take action on the breach and bring the offending property back into line by the use of explanations or sanctions.

The key is to research the legal standing of any Code of Practice you have to deal with to determine the legal standing of the code.

Competitive factors

As competitors introduce new services and facilities, the nature of our industry is we are often forced to respond and match their offerings or introduce something else in opposition to it. The key here is we have to know what the competitors are doing.

Knowing what the competition is doing in the marketplace is a critical aspect of strategic planning for any business project or program.

This knowledge can determine:

- Which target markets the establishment will develop
- Where opportunities may exist
- Suitability of target markets and source locations
- Current level of competitiveness.

Identifying the competition

It is important to identify the main competitors to your business including their:

- Name
- Address
- Number of staff
- Strengths and weaknesses.

This knowledge will assist you in formulating competitive strategies to lure their customers to your business.



Analysing the competition

When analysing the competition, it is useful to gather evidence of the following:

- Who are they, and where are they located
- Facilities available
- Location and distribution area that they have established
- Target markets they appear to have set
- How well they present to potential customers
- Territory
- Customer accounts
- Product and service mix
- An objective assessment of the quality of their product/service – Are they providing good quality, costs, variations, reliable service, acceptable trading hours, and value-for-money?
- Their promotional mix – what they do in terms of advertising, when and how
- Packaging or presentation
- Their pricing structure – Do they give discounts, trade-ins, and a wholesale and retail structure?
- Access
- Continuity
- Volume
- Trading terms
- Service standards that are being delivered
- Their level of customer service – What do they provide? Are their staff good at selling and service?
- Degree of alignment between the promises being made and actual service delivery
- Customer satisfaction.
- The market share that the competition is enjoying
- The significance of their market share of the market in the local area.



Contractual obligations

Like in any business activity, all new projects or programs must not conflict with existing obligations or contracts which an organisation may have with suppliers, governments or other stakeholders.

In many cases, new initiatives may further enhance the relationship with suppliers and indeed increase the level of co-operation through the introduction of new products and services.



Integration with other programs and projects

It is important that any new initiatives are timed to align with other activities that the organisation may be undertaking.

In many cases, the amount of resources that can be allocated to projects and programs will be limited and allocated accordingly based on prepared budgets and schedules timelines.

Advertised timelines for availability or implementation

Depending on the resources required for projects and programs, there may be timing issues relating to the availability or timing of receiving resources.

In addition, new products and services, resulting from the introduction of new projects may have an advertised 'start date' which will drive the urgency of activities and priority of resources to meet these deadlines.

Weather and seasonality factors

Some projects may be influenced by seasonal demand or weather patterns.

For example, tourism organisations may plan and implement new programs in off-peak times when suitable time can be allocated.

Some activities will be implemented due peak times to help maximise revenue for an organisation.

In addition, construction of new products and services may only be able to be completed during 'dry seasons' to reduce the amount of lost time due to inclement weather.



Common conflict factors

Besides the list of factors that will impact on possible projects and programs, the following have sometimes been the cause of problems with communities when attempting to develop tourism initiatives in communities:

- Competition for local government resources – where communities or individual stakeholders or groups believe:
 - Limited existing government resources will be moved away from their traditional use and allocated to another unwanted or non-preferred use
 - Future funding will be channelled towards the proposed tourism initiatives at the expense of other local requirements which they regard as having more importance
- Conflicting opinions about tourism development options – where there is a lack of agreement between stakeholders as to which of several options for development should be given priority and allocated limited resources
- Perceived threat to local amenity by high visitor numbers – where communities, individuals, groups and families are frightened about the impact and influx of increased numbers of people into their area, businesses and facilities
- Conflicting opinions regarding local government levies for tourism – this occurs where local government proposes imposing a levy for the development of tourism in the area and:
 - There is debate over whether the tax should be imposed
 - Who should be required to pay the tax
 - How the money that is collected should be spent
 - How the amount payable as a levy should be calculated
 - When and how it is payable
- Conflict between environmental and business groups – who may:
 - Disagree over the impact the proposed initiatives will have on the environment
 - Disagree about the economic benefit the initiatives will generate
 - Hold conflicting opinions about the relative merits of the economy versus the environment
- Misunderstanding regarding the relative benefits and disadvantages of tourism to the host community – in terms of a variety of matters commonly related to the standard factors of:
 - Social issues
 - Cultural issues
 - Economic issues
 - Crime
 - Disruption to 'normal' life
 - Destruction of the amenity of the area



- Misinterpretation and misunderstanding of the effects of tourism on other host communities – where local communities:
 - Believe they are being misinformed about the benefits tourism has brought to other communities
 - Believe they are not told about the negative impacts of tourism initiatives on other communities
 - Are unable to understand the facts, figures and proposals made by those who are promoting the tourism programs and initiatives.



Activity 3 - Identify factors influencing new projects and programs



Use a variety of resources to investigate factors that may impact on your new project or program.

For each category, note down the major factors you believe will impact on your proposed activities.

FACTOR CATEGORIES	EXAMPLES OF IMPACTS
Economic factors	
Environmental factors	
Technological factors	

FACTOR CATEGORIES	EXAMPLES OF IMPACTS
Political factors	
Social factors	
Legal factors	
Competitive factors	

FACTOR CATEGORIES	EXAMPLES OF IMPACTS
Contractual obligations	
Integration with other programs and projects	
Advertised timelines for availability or implementation	
Weather and seasonality factors	
Common conflicts	



Identify feasibility for new projects and programs

Based on all the factors identified in this section, it is important to identify if it is feasible to actually undertake the project or program what you are envisaging on implementing.

Naturally with any evaluation, it must be based on established criteria.

Criteria may relate to:

- Achievement of established objectives
- Availability of resources and equipment
- Code of ethics
- Cost effectiveness
- Fulfilment of purpose
- Impact to organisation
- Innovativeness of ideas or concepts
- Level of risk
- Level of skill, and understanding required for implementation
- Potential benefits
- Suitability for target clients
- Technical feasibility
- Time needed to realise concept.



As can be seen in this section, there are many factors that must be considered before implementing new tourism projects and programs.

1.3 Develop program/project plans

Introduction

Now that the various factors that may impact on a project or program have been considered with a feasibility being undertaken to determine if the project and program elements are plausible or not, it is now time to develop plans that will guide the implementation of project/program activities.

In summary, project/program plans focus on:

- The end result and what needs to be done to get there
- How it is to be done.

These plans specify the details of how project's objectives are to be achieved.

It sets out of what activities are required from different people at different times and outlines the performance indicators against which each activity will be assessed.



Importance of developing tourism projects and program plans

It is essential that plans to be in writing because this:

- Identifies all activities in a logical and sequential order
- Provides a clear outline of the project activities
- Provides a constant reference point
- Facilitates the sharing of the plan
- Forces all or more planning considerations to be undertaken
- Allows for informed feedback in relation to the plan.



The driving force behind developing a project/program plan is that there must be a need for the plan.

It is important that when preparing a project/program plan that the content contained in the plan:

- Aligns with the Mission of the business
- Supports the stated Vision of the organisation
- Reflects the public Value Statements made by the business
- Helps achieve the desired image of the business
- Helps achieve the desired market position of the business in the marketplace.



Activities associated with developing project and program plans

Naturally the type of project and program will dictate the activities to be completed when developing plans.

That said, activities that are commonly required for all projects and programs include, but not limited to:

- Identifying relevant acquisition strategies for materials, information and resources required for the program/project
- Developing a specific budget and financial management strategy
- Developing communication and contract management plans, where applicable
- Generating details cost estimates
- Preparing evaluation criteria for program/project progress and completion
- Determining final expected outcomes and measurable benefits of the program/project
- Developing intellectual property strategies, where applicable
- Determining program/project milestones
- Clarifying/revising program/project objectives and purpose, including confirming or clarifying the rationale for the program/project
- Defining program/project deliverables and criteria for evaluating acceptance of same
- Developing a human resource plan, where applicable, describing training, staff involved, time commitment, authority and communication structure
- Developing performance indicators
- Describing project control mechanisms
- Developing program/project implementation and governance strategy
- Defining quality assurance and quality control strategies for the program/project
- Identifying program/project resource requirements, including human, physical and financial
- Developing risk management protocols for the program/project
- Defining relevant roles and responsibilities for those involved in the program/project
- Deciding schedules and timelines
- Defining tasks and activities
- Coordinating staff
- Preparing program/project-specific documentation
- Processing income and payments relating to the program/project
- Planning general and specific project activities
- Planning administrative tasks specific to the program/project.



These steps will be explained in more detail in the following sections of this manual.

Contents of the project / program plan

Some tourism organisations will have existing templates that are used for developing project plans, often similar to business plans.

A project/program plan may include:

- Identification of the type of the project/plan
- A summary of the purpose of the plan
- Explanation for the need for the project / program
- Identification of objectives to be achieved
- Breakdown of long-term and short term goals
- Service performance measures and metrics
- Key Performance Indicators
- Identification of key stakeholders
- Key roles and responsibilities
- Overall schedule of proposed activities against a timeline
- Detail of activities to be conducted as part of the project/ program including:
 - Daily priorities
 - Weekly priorities
 - Regular duties or work tasks
- Workflow processes and standard operating procedures for implementation
- Budget and resources required to implement plan
- Potential risks and mitigating actions to manage the risks
- Contingency plans
- Reporting plans
- Timelines for completion.



Activity 4 - Prepare a project / program plan

Based on the examples in this section, please prepare a project plan for the project/program you have identified in Activity 2.



1.4 Link budget to key outcomes

Introduction

One of the tools that assists project managers to plan and monitor finances associated with programs is a good budgeting system.

The product of this system is a document called a budget.

Normally budgets are short-term plans of up to one year; however they may be prepared for the expected life of a project or program.

Plans for the longer term are not usually made into budgets because there are so many unknown factors as the term grows longer that putting precise quantity or monetary values on plans becomes difficult.

They are expressed in monetary terms with projected revenues and expenses allocated to different line items or categories.



1	0.00	0	0	0
2	18 995	51 778	51 778	0
3	11 852	0	0	0
4	1 451	16013	1 451	0
5	842	17182	17 182	0
6	0.00	21 201	2 120	0
7	0.00	21 188	2 188	0
8	0.00	5272	5 272	0
9	0.00	28013	0	0
10	0.00	56286	0	0
11	0.00	75872	90	0
12	0.4	10768	2008	2 008
13	0.8	169416	16226	16 226
14	0.00	21499	2186	2 186
15	0.00	22137	0	0
16	1.2	258399	0	0
17	0.00	1 188	1188	0
18	0.00	0	300	0

Basis for budgets

Budgets function on the basis that:

- Each project will have a budgetary goal based on the project objectives – that is, what it wants to achieve in terms of a financial outcome for the period in question
- These objectives will be achieved in theory by following a budgetary plan – that is, a forecast of what income and expenditures are expected for the period
- Progress for the period will be monitored by budgetary control. That includes on-going comparisons between predicted and actual figures, combined with action to rectify variances.

In essence, a budget can be seen as a guide, a map of the upcoming period in a financial sense.

It tells us where we are going to be, how we expect to get there, and how we are going on our trip.

Linking budgets to project objectives

The budgeting process will make project management forward thinking about what resources are needed and when and where they should be used.

It is traditional for the project objectives to guide budget priorities including the allocation of resources.

As mentioned, funds are allocated to achieve the objectives of the project or program.

These objectives are broken down into plans for departments or activities who in turn usually adapt these into revenue and expense budgets.

The objectives deemed to be most important will attract a higher level of funding than lesser ones.



It is also during this stage that resources are allocated more specifically as to their use to achieve these plans. For example purchases to be made, employees to be hired.

Link budget to key objectives should include:

- Prioritising outcomes
- Ensuring accountability and transparency
- Ensuring all resource types are involved as required, such as human, physical and financial
- Developing explanatory notes to supplement the allocation of resources.

Types of budgets

Managing a project or program involves managing many aspects of operation, such as sales, purchasing, labour, research, marketing, rent or other occupancy costs, utilities (electricity, gas, water), maintenance of equipment and furnishings, purchase of new equipment and furnishings, and a multitude of small items that are all needed to meet the objectives of the project or program

All of these will be reflected in one budget type or another. All of them will affect the flow of cash in and out, so separate budgets are prepared for cash flow.

In projects that generate revenue, they will reflect some profit or loss over a year or designated periods or milestones of the project, so all must be brought together in a comprehensive report on profit performance, in which all revenues and all operating costs are combined.

Types of budgets that may be used for projects or programs include:

- Sales budgets – to forecast sales revenue
- Labour budgets – to forecast labour expenses
- Material budgets – to forecast purchases of goods for sale or for use in preparing finished products
- Inventory budget – planning quantities to be held in stock, and the amount of money invested in stock
- Overhead budgets – concerns other estimated operating expenses (E.g. Rent, rates, etc.)
- Capital Expenditure budgets – plans for long-term assets to be purchased, replaced, upgraded
- Budgeted Financial Performance Statement – concerns estimated profit or loss. This brings together several of the above budgets, for sales, material, labour, overheads, inventory
- Cash budgets – concerns the estimated cash inflow, cash outflow and cash position of a business
- Budgeted Statement of Financial Position – concerns estimated values of assets, liabilities and owners' equity at the end of a budget period.



Key requirements for budgets

When preparing budgets it is important to identify:

- The time frame or period to which the budget applies
- The budget line items to be included, including what is contained in each budget line items
- What departments or areas of responsibility individual budget line items will be grouped towards
- Budget line codes.

Estimating project/program revenue

In the case of projects that are expected to generate revenue there will be a need to estimate what the sales figures will be for the up-coming period.

Reasons to estimate revenue

This estimation, which is little more than an 'educated guess', serves two important functions:

- It sets the 'projected' figure for income for the period – this may be done on a simple annual basis (that is, it will just identify a dollar figure for the entire year or project), or it may follow a different format and identify sales by (for example) each month or project activity
- The performance of the revenue-generating project will, in part, be judged against this figure
- It may form the basis of the expense budget – because many expense items are calculated as a set percentage of sales.

Considerations when estimating revenue

'Sales' are also known as 'revenue' or 'income'.

Estimating sales is a difficult exercise, especially for new innovative projects that may never have been undertaken before.

Considerations when determining sales include, but not limited to:

- Aims of the project or program
- Competition
- Economy
- History
- Industry trends
- Other similar projects or programs
- Sales targets
- Key Performance Indicators
- Seasonality.



Estimating project/program expenses

This can be a lengthy exercise and is something that requires detailed thought as all possible costs should be identified and calculated.

This is a complex exercise as many costs cannot be foreseen and actual costs are often greater than the amount initially envisaged.

In brief, every 'substantial' expense item must be looked at and this can include, for example:

- Materials
- Employees
- Equipment
- Contracted labour
- Compensation
- Products
- Rent
- Advertising
- Insurance
- Office expenses
- Maintenance
- Capital expenditures.



It is important to know, as best as can be determined, the quantities of these items needed for the entire project or for key activities associated with the program.

This exercise is essential in determining what is required before negotiations can be made with suppliers.

Suppliers of materials are often prepared to negotiate prices but in return they are usually looking for on-going business from you. It is a balancing act in many ways.

Suppliers may allow you not to pay for goods bought from them for six months but may want to sell to you at premium prices and seek to lock you into a buying contract for a longer period of time.

Activities in estimating project expenses

The activities involved in estimating costs can include:

- Identifying each possible cost
- Calculating projected volumes or items required
- Factoring contingency costs
- Obtaining quotations, price lists and catalogues from potential suppliers
- Negotiating prices with suppliers.

Establish budget control and monitoring guidelines

Control and monitoring guidelines are imperative for budgets. Without these guidelines the budgets are nothing more than a collection of figures.

It is the controls and the monitoring guidelines that give substance and ‘teeth’ to the whole concept of budgets.

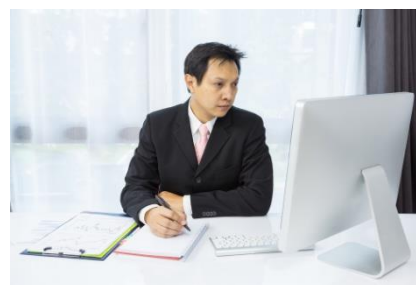
It is a complete waste of time and effort to prepare budgets unless control and monitoring guidelines are generated and unless they are implemented.

It is to be expected that the controls and the monitoring guidelines will be spelled out in the relevant policies so that all those who are impacted by them have ready access to what the requirements are.

Revenue budget controls

Common controls over revenue budgets include:

- Requiring a receipt to be given for each sale made
- Requiring all monies taken on behalf of the business to be forwarded to the business
- Requiring a nominated paper-trail (audit trail) to be followed for every revenue centre
- Banking receipts to match journal entries.
- Restricting methods of payment to nominated methods only – this may, for example, prohibit
- Credit sales or payment by personal cheque
- Requiring payment by certain dates – such as requiring ‘cash payment’ for most sales and requiring accounts to be settled within 30 days
- Limiting the personnel who may handle cash or accept payments and issue receipts
- Restricting the classifications of people or groups who may receive discounts or be eligible for any special deals that include any form of price reduction
- Specifying internal cash handling protocols – to safeguard revenue after it has been received. This will also include the banking procedures followed by establishment staff
- Limiting the people who can enter data into budget files – these are traditionally restricted to management or accounts staff
- Limiting access to the budget files– to eliminate the possibility of fraudulent entries
- Requiring all revenue nominated source revenue documentation to be completed with the correct budget codes – to facilitate posting of income to the correct budget lines.



Expense budget controls

Common controls over expenses and expenditure budgets include:

- Requiring all purchases to be accompanied by an official Purchase Order
- Requiring purchases above nominated dollar amounts to receive written authorisation before the purchase is made
- Requiring three quotations for purchases over a specified amount
- Requiring a nominated paper audit trail to be followed for every purchase made. For example, the trail would commonly be:
 - Purchase order
 - Delivery docket
 - Invoice
 - Statement
 - Credit notes (where applicable)
- Prohibiting personal purchases of any kind, and for any amount, being made through the business
- Requiring any internal transfer of stock to be accompanied by a requisition
- Requiring stock takes to be conducted at regular intervals.



Monitoring budgets

Budget monitoring involves two aspects.

The first is the monitoring of the controls to ensure they are being implemented with:

- Monitoring of budgets should be scheduled – on a regular and frequent basis
- Monitoring of budgets must also address all the controls that have been prescribed to ensure all controls are being complied with as intended without exceptions.

This will involve personal observation of practice, and the checking of documentation.

Secondly, monitoring of the budgets must address comparison of the 'actual' figures against the 'projected' figures to determine whether or not the budgets are on-track and if remedial action needs to be implemented.



When comparing these figures it is essential to verify:

- All legitimate expenses have been allocated to the budget – a check may be part of the monitoring process to validate the posting of expenses to budget lines
- It is also important to ensure all the expenses for this period are included in the budget - otherwise a distorted view can be obtained especially where the income figures have been posted but certain high expenditure figures have not
- The expense figures that have been posted reflect the figures on the supporting documents
- Accurate revenue figures have been posted –taking into account any discounts or commissions payable.



Activity 5 - Prepare a project / program budget

You are required to:

- Conduct research into different budget templates that can be used for projects or programs
- Prepare a budget plan for the project/program you have identified in Activity 2.



1.5 Allocate resources

1.11 Select program/project management tools

2.5 Maintain program/project records

Introduction

In order for a new project or program to be successful in being able to meet its objectives, it is vital that every aspect of the planned project or program activities and initiatives are being conducted to schedule, in line with timing deadlines and conducted to the best of its ability.

Therefore project management must constantly assess and evaluate the performance of all project activities that contribute to the overall program.

All project activities must be monitored to find out:

- If they reflect the project objectives
- What is being done correctly
- Are in line with time and budget requirements
- What needs improvement, by identifying causes and remedies.



Establish monitoring and reporting arrangements

Whilst each project is unique, common monitoring and reporting arrangements may include:

- Financial management arrangements
- Record keeping
- Reporting framework and schedule, including team reports
- Project management software and other tools, such as Gantt and bar charts
- Program Evaluation and Review Technique (PERT)
- Critical Path Method
- Cost schedule control system
- Spreadsheets
- Charts including project control chart, control point chart
- Milestone chart and budget control chart
- Defining report requirements, including contents, report structure and relevant timelines for report presentations.



In Section 2.3, the process of monitoring and evaluating projects and programs will be discussed in more detail.



Activity 6 - Research project management software



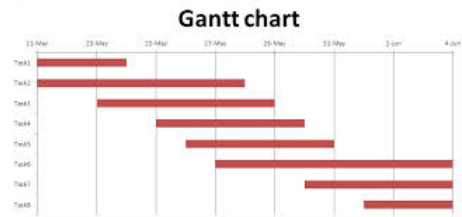
You are required to conduct research into the different types of project management software that can be used to manage and monitor project performance.

Name of project management software	
Website of company	
Key features of the software	
Cost of the software	
Advantages of using the software / program	
Disadvantages of using the software / program	



Activity 7 - Explain project management tools

You are required to conduct research and provide a summary, including benefits, of the following project management tools:



Gantt Charts

Bar Charts

Program Evaluation and Review Technique (PERT)

Critical Path Method

Identify clear evaluation criteria

Whilst it is essential to have clear information regarding new projects and their implementation, it is important that formal evaluation criteria are included to determine the success and effectiveness of new concepts, after they are implemented.

All new concepts must be evaluated to ensure it meets the requirements for the targets and more importantly target customers.

Such evaluation helps to make sure the efforts stays on track and forces suggestions to be based in reality.

Analysing the effectiveness of products and services provided to customers is important at any stage of its lifecycle, but is essential when it is first introduced into the market.



Any aspect of the introduction of new products and services can be monitored and evaluated with a view to improvement.

Therefore it is important to establish clear evaluation criteria before it actually commences.

Aim of monitoring project activities

It is important to note, monitoring and evaluation activities is not about 'telling people off'. It is about trying to improve all aspects of a project or program.

Aims of monitoring and evaluating project or program performance include:

- If the concept works
- Identifying areas which are being done well and rewarding accordingly
- Identifying where areas can be improved through:
 - Identification of problems
 - Understanding the cause
 - Finding suitable solutions
 - Selecting the correct solution
 - Implementing and monitoring the solution
- If it meets established needs
- If it adds value to the customer
- If it adds value to the organisation
- What contributes as sufficient contacts or sales made
- If the concept comes in on budget
- If the campaign or idea achieve the stated objectives
- Feedback from customers and agencies
- Implications for future undertakings
- Changes to be made in the future.



Areas to evaluate

These can include:

- The procedures or systems
- The workflow and workload for staff
- Whether or not there are gaps or overlaps in service provision
- The time it takes to do a task or job
- Job design
- Level of customer satisfaction with the service or product provided
- Cost
- Level of interest created and demand patterns
- Ease of implementation
- Increase in sales or leads
- Return on investment.



Activity 8 - Identify areas to evaluate

You are required to identify the different aspects of your project or program you wish to evaluate. Try to identify methods that you can use to evaluate these aspects.

PROJECT ASPECTS TO EVALUATE	METHODS TO EVALUATE ASPECTS

Establish reporting arrangements

Naturally a flow on from evaluating project performance is the need to report findings.

Therefore there is a need to determine what the reporting procedures will be in terms of 'the establishment' reporting project performance back to the 'relevant' people.

Decision to be taken about reports

The basics that need to be decided on include:

- The types of reports to be prepared
- What information is to be included in reports
- Who is to prepare reports
- The frequency with which reports are to be generated and disseminated
- The distribution list of who will receive these reports
- The method that will be used to disseminate the reports.

General report requirements

All reports, regardless of their content must be:

- Accurate
- Simple and unambiguous
- Timely.

In Section 2.4 the process of reporting findings will be explained in more detail.





Activity 9 - Identify reporting mechanisms

You are required to identify the different reporting mechanisms you would have to report the performance findings for your project or program.



The types of reports to be prepared	
What information is to be included in reports	
Who is to prepare reports	
The frequency with which reports are to be generated and disseminated	
The distribution list of who will receive these reports	
The method that will be used to disseminate the reports	

1.6 Allocate resources

Introduction

The key aspects of achieving project or program success is through the use of capabilities and resources.

Whilst it is important to review the 'end results' as identified in previous sections, it is important to identify the capabilities and resources used in successfully undertaking projects or programs.

This section will explore in more detail the different types of capabilities and resources that apply to travel and tourism operations. In addition it will look at the local tourism infrastructure and possible community resources that can be used to supplement resources obtained by the organisation.

In Section 2.1 the activities associated with assigning responsibilities to the greatest resource, people, will be discussed in more detail.



Activities associated with allocating resources

There are many activities that need to be undertaken when allocating resources. These include, but not limited to:

- Establishing budgets
- Establishing scopes of authority and discretionary powers relating to resources
- Defining systems and procedures to guide the use and application of resources
- Prioritising operational activities
- Scheduling tasks and the overall workload for the program/project
- Breaking tasks into sub-tasks
- Arranging tasks into groups, where applicable
- Facilitating team involvement in task and resources allocations
- Allocating responsibilities to align with resources provided
- Delegating tasks
- Imposing constraints and limitations on resource availability and usage
- Establishing line/chain of command protocols for managing resource use between joint venture partners, including private and public sector funding sources.



Types of capabilities

Types of capabilities may include:

- Products or services
- Capacity to produce goods or services
- Equipment capacity
- Skill level of staff, management and owners
- Hours of operation
- Communication capabilities
- Location/position of the business
- E-business capacity
- Need for specialist assistance in certain areas
- Maintaining a competitive advantage.



Types of resources

The use of resources is important activities in tourism project or program.

There is a need to make sure the organisation has the resources it needs to achieve its identified project objectives, while at the same time, ensuring that money is not wasted on resources that are not necessary or inappropriate to the task.

Resources can encompass:

- Physical resources
- Human resources
- Financial resources
- Intangible resources.

Physical resources

These types of resources are essential in performing basic operational activities.

They include:

- Equipment
- Raw materials
- Stock
- Technology
- Location.



Human resources

From an operational point of view, given that we are a 'services industry' the importance of staff in delivering this service component is of upmost importance.

Human resources include:

- Physical number of staff
- Staff expertise
- Skills
- Knowledge.

These will be influenced by:

- Recruitment
- Probation periods
- Remuneration
- Incentive schemes
- Work environment
- Training and development
- Your leadership style.



Types of other human resources required for service operations may include:

- Customer databases
- Outsourced parties (third party service providers)
- Service team members, which may include cross functional teams
- Other stakeholders which may be involved in an organisation's service
- Value chain.

Financial resources

Whilst this is often not determined on an operational level, it is still important to recognise the importance of this type of resource. In many cases budgets will have the greatest impact on terms of financial resources available for operational managers.

Types of financial resources include:

- Cash
- Stock
- Equity
- Loans.

Intangible resources

Whilst these are not 'seen' they are certainly important in the service industry.

These resources include:

- Reputation
- Good will
- Image / Brand
- Brand.



Factors affecting capabilities and resources

There are a number of factors that will need to be considered when determining capabilities and resourcing needs.

Internal factors

- Nature of the project or program
- Project activities
- Directions the business wishes to take
- Target markets
- Service levels and standards
- Services and products provided
- Equipment used
- The existing reputation and image of the business
- Budget
- Existing resources
- Volume of customers
- Promises made.



External factors

- The external business environment
- Customer expectations
- Emerging trends
- Changes in legislation and technology
- Availability of resources.



Activity 10 - Identify resources required for your project / program

For your organisation you are required to identify the different resources that you would require to undertake your project or program.



TYPE OF RESOURCE	EXAMPLES
Physical resources (List of all items required)	
Human resources (List of different positions)	
Financial resources (Estimate costings to purchased physical assets)	

Utilising community resources

As well as gathering and using resources from within the organisation itself, there may be a range of resources within the local community that may also be used to undertake project activities.

The more specific and accurate information in regards to available community and industry resources is gathered, the better chances of success a tourism project or program will have.

An audit of the community and industry resources will support a successful implementation by understanding:

- Preparedness and readiness of individual tourism operators to contribute to and support projects
- Local skills profile - existing level versus required level of training required for the project implementation
- Extent and condition of local infrastructure -from local airport to roads and public amenities and buildings such as visitors centres, hotels
- Current market position of the destination and community - as determined when completing a situation analysis, market mix, market mix knowledge, consumer trends and visitor peaks and troughs cycles need to be established.



Types of local community resources

- Material such as informative data, infrastructure
- Financial such as grants, sponsorships
- Human such as local skills, tourism operators' readiness.

Identifying local community resources

- Local government data bases
- Local tourism associations or other industry bodies
- Potential for grants and other assistance at a national, regional or state level
- Sponsorship or joint ventures with tourism businesses, operators
- Expertise of those likely to implement plans such as local authorities.



Identify tourism infrastructure inventory and tourism carrying capacity

An audit and assessment of the existing tourism infrastructure and carrying capacity allows an organisation to understand the extent which not only the project can be implemented but also the extent in which public resources can be obtained or used.

The inventory needs to cover:

- Transport
- Accommodation capability and capacity
- Levels of infrastructure
- Local attractions
- Retail infrastructure
- Car parks
- Public toilets
- Gardens and parks
- Shops, shopping malls, centres
- Entertainment centres such as cinemas, theatres
- Post office
- Petrol service stations
- Pubs, Clubs
- Hospitals, doctors' surgeries.



The projection of the use of existing infrastructures and the impact needs to be considered when planning projects or programs.

All of the above qualified data must also be quantified in order to provide overall accurate data for possible use.

Each country has dedicated bureaux, organisations collating and providing tourism qualitative and quantitative information very useful for the development of projects or programs that involve regional tourism and the local community.





Activity 11 - Identify local community resources

You are required to identify local community resources that can be used to help implement or support your proposed tourism project or program.

TYPE OF RESOURCE	HOW IT CAN BE USED	HOW IT CAN BE OBTAINED	ASSOCIATED COSTS



1.7 Integrate program/plan with other initiatives

Introduction

To date, we have focused on the planning and development of individual tourism projects and programs. Whilst these initiatives, especially those that are innovative, causing greater challenges and effort, due to the need to develop everything often from scratch, they are not the only focus of an operation.

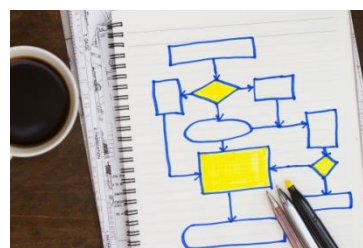
This section will identify the other activities that a business will be conducting, in addition to individual projects and programs and also techniques used to ensure integration of all business activities can be achieved without negatively impacting on each other.

Importance of integrating all business initiatives

Whilst it is important to plan each project or program as a separate entity, it is still vital to remember that a tourism organisation will be conducting other activities simultaneously.

These activities include, but not limited to:

- Normal operational activities
- Marketing
- Special promotions
- Events
- Training and development initiatives
- Refurbishments or upgrading of resources
- Other programs or projects.



Given that all operations have limited resources, as identified in Section 1.6, it is important that each project, program and business activity is conducted to ensure maximum efficiency and synergy.

Whilst it may appear that the greater the number of activities conducted by an organisation will negatively impact on other initiatives being undertaken, as efforts and energy needs to be split to accommodate everything being conducted, in many cases, these activities can actually complement each other.

For example, a project aimed at introducing unique eco-tourism educational walks can also generate greater revenues for other tours and activities offered to customers.

Types of integrating considerations

Whilst the types of integration activities will depend on the complexity, size and nature of activities to be integrated, considerations include:

- Capitalising on economies of scale
- Utilising staff with complementary skills, knowledge and experience in associated areas and disciplines
- Minimising unnecessary duplication
- Centralising operations to facilitate control and minimise expenditure.



Activity 12 - Integrate all business activities

You are required to identify all the different business activities that will also be conducted by a tourism organisation, and methods to ensure your project or program can be integrated in a synergistic manner.



What are the other business activities that are conducted on a daily basis?

Describe how your project or program positively impact or benefit other business activities?

Describe how you can achieve 'economies of scale' when integrating your project or program with normal business activities?

How can you reduce unnecessary duplication of resources?

1.8 Confirm agreements with service providers

Introduction

Given that most innovative projects or programs will involve many activities, using much needed resources, provided by a range of internal and external suppliers, it is important that all necessary approvals and agreements confirmed with all necessary stakeholders.

This is especially true when the project or program is a new concept, where success is not guaranteed or there are no prior arrangements in place for the provision of products and services that are required to conduct the project or program.

This phase is pivotal to the success of the proposed projects and programs. It is a matter of 'selling' your concept to all concerned parties and can be achieved in various ways to get the most exposure and target all audiences from the government bodies to the local stakeholders.

Whilst this process is primarily focused on getting approval and confirming agreements, it also provides a great opportunity to gather constructive feedback from those with specialised knowledge to help steer the project or program in the right direction.

This section will explore the different types of approvals and agreements that must be confirmed when developing innovative projects and programs.



Obtaining approval or support for implementation of projects or programs

Once the plans have been finalised it is now time to get official approval and support to move to the implementation phase, which will be discussed in Section 2 of this manual.

Approval may simply be getting the 'yes' from management, however may involve the approval from the local community and associated regulatory bodies.

Methods to obtain approval

Approvals may be gained by:

- Private meetings and submissions with executive panels and senior management
- Public meetings presentation so the project can be presented and clearly explained. It is recommended to hold those public meetings in the local community, for example at the town hall
- Media release from an official 'launch' article to loading the project on the organisation website, and social media, depending, as previously mentioned, on the level of technology available



- Providing soft and hard as required to all officially involved stakeholders such as
 - Board members and senior management
 - Designated government agencies
 - Industry bodies such as industry associations
 - Other bodies or organisations such as Chamber of Commerce, Tourism office bureau and other local organisations
- Formally registering and submitting project plans to designated authorities expected to take over the areas that are targeted for development such as the local planning authority, a consortium in charge of developing a resort, cultural park etc.



Official approval funds approval

Funding is indispensable for the implementation of a tourism projects and must be also be granted by management or by the relevant authorities and bodies.

Similar to the official authorisation, the deciding boards, authorities or bodies may vary according to the country, region. Funding is commonly integrated in the official authorisation as a budget would have been allocated for new projects and programs.

- Official, government funding with a view of developing responsible tourism growth

Depending on the country, region, the authorities granting the official permission can be:

- National such as federal governments
 - State, regional and provincial bodies
 - Local councils and communities
- Private funding with a view on return on investment.

Community approval

As already mentioned community approval is critical to the success of any regional tourism project. General approval by all or most of the community members will ensure the next stage, the implementation stage can proceed.

Using the same information dissemination mediums as for the initial plan presentation will guarantee to keep the communication and dialogue happening.



Feedback

Whether was part of the approval process or as a separate activity, feedback may be sought in regards to projects or programs proposed for implementation.

It is vital that enough time is allocated and timelines publicised for all concerned stakeholders to get themselves familiar with all the aspects of the project or program plan and provide valuable and constructive feedback.

For ease of understanding it is essential the project plan is well structured and clearly addresses the following elements:

- Strategic planning process
- Steering committees
- Review process
- Approval mechanism
- Contingency plans.



Activity 13 - Identify approval requirements

You are required to identify:

- The stakeholders, either internal or external to the organisation, that need to approve projects or programs
- What documentation is needed to obtain the approval?



STAKEHOLDERS WHO GRANT APPROVAL FOR PROJECTS/PROGRAMS	DOCUMENTATION REQUIRED TO GAIN APPROVAL

Explore the potential for joint ventures and strategic alliances

Where new projects or programs incorporate activities or initiatives that are outside the normal business stream, there may an opportunity for your business to form a joint venture or strategic alliance with another organisation



Activity 14 - Identify strategic alliances



You are required to identify organisations that can be possible strategic partners in the implementation of new tourism projects or programs.

POTENTIAL STRATEGIC PARTNER	AREAS OF EXPERTISE OR ALLIANCE

Confirming agreements with service suppliers

Finally, once all the necessary final approvals have been given to commence projects and programs, it is now time to confirm agreements with service providers.

Agreements with service providers may include:

- Legally contracted arrangements
- Word-of-mouth agreements
- Previous services provided by suppliers
- Negotiating changes to existing arrangements
- Clarifying issues
- Establishing operational protocols to guide/control the integration of service providers into the program/project.





Activity 15 - Identify service providers

You are required to identify:

- The service providers that you may need to help implement projects / programs
- Names of organisations
- The types of assistance required. (products, services, technical skills, licensing etc.)

TYPES OF SERVICE PROVIDERS	NAME OF ORGANISATIONS	TYPES OF ASSISTANCE REQUIRED



1.9 Develop contingency plans

Introduction

Contingency plans need to be prepared for all possible risk situations that may occur during the implementation of projects or programs.

It is natural and responsible to think about all the possible problems that may take during the implementation phase, and it is prudent to identify possible actions that need to take place in the event that these anticipated problems come to fruition.

This section defines contingency plans and identifies circumstances and situations for which they may need to be prepared.



Introduction to contingency plans

Contingency plans are plans developed to address foreseeable but unplanned problems in given areas of project implementation.

They are your 'Plan B'.

They detail what action needs to be taken when the situation described as the topic of the project plan arises.

Part of standard risk management protocols is to develop a suite of contingency plans.

Not all identified risks will necessitate the development of a contingency plan. The nature of the identified risk and the associated Consequences and Likelihood will be the prime determinants of whether or not these plans need to be prepared.

Consequences relate directly to the potential for 'the event' to impact on the success of the project and impact it can have on the organisation or community.

A contingency is a set of circumstances which the organisation has identified as being something which could probably happen to impact the project but are unlikely to happen.



The 'set of circumstances' can be big or small. It is the impact or consequences which flow which should determine whether or not a contingency plan should be developed.

Importance of planning for unforeseen events

Reasons to plan for unforeseen events include:

- To provide direction for employees and the business in the event of negative situations
- To mitigate negative outcomes when unforeseen circumstances materialise
- To allow the project or program to continue, resume or recover normal business when impacted by negative events
- Because things do not always go as planned – this is simply a fact of business life
- To address 'due diligence' requirements

- To protect the ongoing viability of the project
- To optimise project performance
- To provide you with a sense of security 'all bases' are covered.

Contingency plans for 'positive' and 'negative' situations

Contingency plans can be developed to address 'problem situations' and while this is the most common focus for contingency plans (see below), it is important to appreciate they can also be prepared to address 'opportunities' too.

Positive situations

Opportunities are positive situations becoming available for the project, business or department to capitalise on.

For example your venue may develop a contingency plan to address a situation where a major competitor closes down – identifying the actions you should take to benefit in the most positive manner from this eventuality.



Negative situations

Negative situations are defined by the venue but are generally of a severe or catastrophic nature.

They are situations which have the capacity to significantly impact the operation of the business.

Some people argue all risk management plans can be seen as 'contingency plans'.

Contingency plan activities

Before we look at what is to be included in contingency plans it is important to identify the steps associated with developing these plans, including but not limited to:

- Identifying situations that may require contingency management plans, including:
 - Operational issues
 - Time-related issues
 - Changed marketplace conditions
- Obtaining stakeholder agreement
- Identifying trigger points for implementation
- Developing contingency management structure, composition and policies
- Writing and approving draft contingency management plans.



Common contingencies to be addressed

Contingency plans are commonly prepared for circumstances such as:

- Unsuccessful activities
- Substandard work performed by contractors
- Inability of service providers to provide products and services
- Terrorism
- Economic collapse
- Faults and malfunctions occur with significant organisational equipment and systems
- Adverse weather conditions
- Changes to bookings
- Labour disputes
- Funding shortfalls
- Data loss
- Loss of a major client
- Power failure
- Loss or absence of key staff
- Death of customer.



Contents of a contingency plan

The generic contents of a contingency plan are identified below and indicate the aspects of these plans you must address as part of the development process.

Title of the plan

The title of the contingency plan must be such it readily identifies the set of circumstances to which the plan applies.

Where organisations use contingency plans it is likely there will be a suite of them so it is important to be able to distinguish one from another.

All these plans should be the subject of regular review so you need to ensure you have the most current version as they alter to reflect various workplace changes.

Actions to take

All contingency plans will have a specified list of actions which need to be taken and a priority order for them to be taken in.

These may be referred to as 'contingency actions'.

Remember in a contingency situation it is not enough for personnel to simply do what is listed in the plan. They also have to do it in the sequence listed to achieve optimum results.

In relation to 'actions to take' you need to:

- Details of the actions the enterprise will take when an operational risk has become a reality and loss or damage has occurred, including identification of necessary scopes of authorities, changes to standard operating procedures, limitations on actions and contact with outside agencies including the media
- Describe the triggers for action
- Processes to retrieve the situation and re-establish normal operating conditions
- Provide specifics – there is a need to detail what has to be done
- Nominate and properly describe items, materials, equipment etc. to be used
- Allocate numbers to action – to assist with identification of actions and sequencing
- Do the most important thing first
- Where the contingency involves a threat to people or property, the safety of people must always take priority over the safety and security of assets
- Consider indicating contingency actions which are specifically prohibited
- Specific actions to retain customers and market share
- Specific actions to maintain industry confidence, stakeholders and customers of the enterprise
- Damage limitation and damage control protocols.



Conditions and circumstances for action

This is a statement in the plan providing details of the 'trigger' for implementing the plan.

It is the basis which must be used for determining implementation of the plan.

While the venue does not want to wait 'too long' before actioning the relevant contingency plan it also does not want to implement it too soon or when it is not necessary or appropriate to do so, because implementing contingency plans can:

- Cost money
- Disrupt normal operations
- Affect the other project / program activities
- Cause alarm to customers.

Responsibilities for actions

The contingency plan will usually allocate responsibility for action. This means a person's name or a job position will be named to undertake nominated tasks under the plan.

This allocation of responsibilities is done to:

- Share the workload
- Ensure important tasks are completed in a timely manner
- Make sure all required activities are undertaken
- Give roles and responsibilities to those best suited to deal with them
- Allocate responsibilities to nominated roles or positions
- Develop an 'integrated whole' in terms of overall operation of the plan.



Timelines

These are timeframes for completion of identified tasks.

There is always an urgency associated with implementation of contingency plans and the timelines help to provide a context in this regard.

They provide:

- Time-related targets to aim for
- The basis for evaluating progress of the plan
- A framework for taking additional action to bring the plan back on track.

Resources

This section of the plan will identify:

- Physical resources to be used to achieve the requirements of the plan
- Information available to support action and decision making
- Limits which apply to the use and expenditure of resources.

Parameters

There will nearly always be a part of the plan addressing the parameters within which the plan can operate.

This may refer to:

- Maximum times the contingency plan can be allowed to operate before the situation is reviewed and a decision made about:
 - Continuing implementation of the contingency plan as it exists
 - Adjusting the contingency plan in some aspect and continuing with it
 - Reverting to standard procedures
- Limits of authority – as they apply to individuals when the contingency plan is triggered. Standard protocols are for nominated persons to have expanded scopes of authority under contingency plans
- Restrictions on action which can be taken. In the same way some employees will be given extra responsibility under a contingency plan, some plans will remove some discretion and powers from certain staff in order to concentrate authority within a revised chain of command
- Limits on spending – given implementation of most contingency plans involves expense of some kind it makes sense for the planning stage to impose limits on what can be spent and where and how funds can be spent.

Intended results

Contingency plans usually include a description of the expected outcome implementation of the plan seeks to achieve.

This is important as it:

- Helps provide a focus for your action
- Gives a context to the plan
- Helps identify when contingency action can stop – because the stated objectives have been reached.



Activity 16 - Prepare a Contingency Plan

Prepare a Contingency Plan based around three 'what ifs' that may affect your project or program.

1.10 Develop teams to support program/project implementation

Introduction

Once all the plans have been identified for proposed projects or programs, it is now time to identify the structure of the different roles required to successfully implement all initiatives and possible learning and development to get personnel equipped to undertake their roles.

In Section 2.1 we will explore in more detail the process of explaining project roles and responsibilities to staff themselves.

Identify team structure for projects / programs

Before you sit down and communicate the project or program requirements with staff, it is firstly vital to have a clear picture of the team to support program or project implementation

This will include identifying:

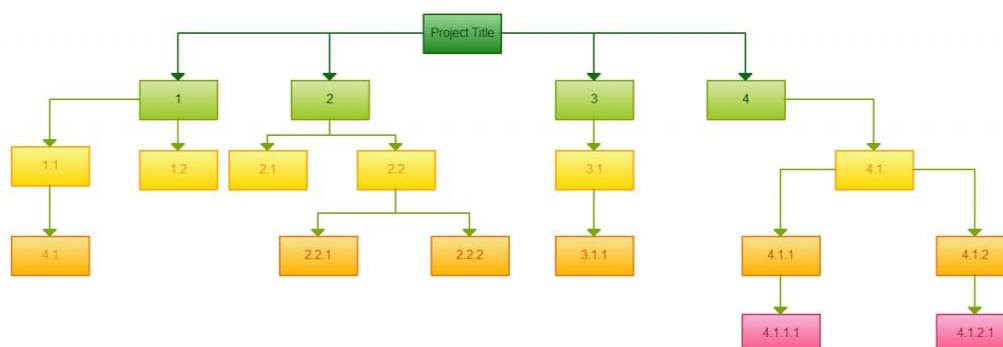
- Structure of the team
- Possible positions and titles
- Lines of authority, responsibility and communication
- Key responsibilities and tasks for each position
- Size of teams for each position
- Selecting appropriate persons by matching team skills to the identified program/project needs, objectives, purpose or outcomes.



Activity 17 - Identify project team structure

You are required to prepare a project structure, including the use of a project hierarchy chart to clearly identify the structure of your project team.

This should briefly outline the information explained above.



Develop project/program team

One of the key requirements for the successful implementation of projects or programs is that the team members are trained and develop the knowledge and skills to undertake the tasks required by them.

The process of implementing training and development for a project team may involve:

- Analyse training needs through gap analysis on project specifications and available capabilities
- Establish training needs for project team
- Organise learning for individuals or in groups
- Monitor learning roadmap to ensure adherence to plan.



Identify learning and development opportunities

There is a need for all training and development activities to be targeted so that each activity optimises the potential for team members not only to learn but apply them to project tasks.

All learning activities should, therefore be selected to ensure they:

- Appropriate to the identified project and learning objectives
- Appropriate, suitable and acceptable to the preferred learning style of participants
- Appropriate to the equipment and resources available to support the activity.

In choosing training events, trainers should take into account the practical, complex and multi-disciplinary nature of the subject area, as well as their participant's prior knowledge, learning styles and abilities.

Types of learning and development opportunities

Whilst most learning and development opportunities traditionally are focused towards formal training, in essence they can be classified as any activity that enables individuals to improve their operational efficiency.

Training events include any activity that will result in learner attainment or progress towards identified workplace attitudes, skills or knowledge.

Following is a brief explanation of common learning and development opportunities that can be used to enable project team members to perform their roles:

Lecture / Tutorial

This is a common method of training involving transfer of information from the trainer to the participants. It is an effective approach to introduce new concepts or information to the learners and also to build upon the existing knowledge. The listener is expected to reflect on the subject and seek clarifications on the doubts.



Demonstration

Demonstration is a very effective training method that involves a trainer showing a participant how to perform a task or activity. Through a visual demonstration, trainers may also explain reasoning behind certain actions or provide supplementary information to help facilitate understanding.

Group Discussions

Brain storming in which all the members in a group expresses their ideas, views and opinion on a given topic, It is a free flow and exchange of knowledge among the participants and the trainer. The discussion is carried out by the group on the basis of their own experience, perceptions and values. This will facilitate acquiring new knowledge. When everybody is expected to participate in the group discussion, even the introvert persons will also get stimulated and try to articulate their feelings.

The ideas that emerged in the discussions should be noted down and presentations are to be made by the groups. Sometimes consensus needs to be arrived on a given topic. Group discussions are to be held under the moderation of a leader guided by the trainer. Group discussion technique, triggers thinking process, encourages interactions and enhances communication skills.



Role Play

This is a common and very effective method of bringing into the classroom real life situations, which may not otherwise be possible. Participants are made to enact a particular role so as to give a real feel of the roles they may be called upon to play. This enables participants to understand the behaviour of others as well as their own emotions and feelings. The instructor must brief the role players on what is expected of them. The role player may either be given a ready-made script, which they can memorise and enact, or they may be required to develop their own scripts around a given situation, thus making the role play more extemporaneous. This technique is extremely useful in understanding creative selling techniques and human relations. It can be entertaining and energising and it helps the reserved and less literate to express their feelings.

Simulation Games

When trainees need to become aware of something that they have not been conscious of, simulations can be a useful mechanism. Simulation games are a method based on "here and now" experience shared by all the participants. The games focus on the participation of the trainees and their willingness to share their ideas with others. Here, a "near real life" situation is created providing an opportunity to which they apply themselves by adopting certain behaviour. They then experience the impact of their behaviour on the situation. It is carried out to generate responses and reactions based on the real feelings of the participants, which are subsequently analysed by the trainer.

While use of simulation games can result in very effective learning, it needs considerable trainer competence to analyse the situations.



Individual /Group Exercises

Exercises are often introduced to find out how much the participant has assimilated. This method involves imparting instructions to participants on a particular subject through use of written exercises. In the group exercises, the entire class is divided into small groups, and members are asked to collaborate to arrive at a consensus or solution to a problem.

Case Study

This is a training method, which enables the trainer and the participant to experience a real life situation. It may be on account of events in the past or situations in the present, in which there may be one or more problems to be solved and decisions to be taken. The basic objective of a case study is to help participants diagnose, analyse or solve particular problem and to make them to internalise the critical inputs delivered in the training. Questions are generally given at the end of the case study to direct the participants and to stimulate their thinking towards possible solutions. Studies may be presented in written or verbal form.



Field Visit

This includes field trips, experiential learning, visits to nominated businesses, sites or venues or guest speakers.

This involves a carefully planned visit or tour to a place of learning or interest. The idea is to give first-hand knowledge by personal observation of field situations, and to relate theory with practice. The emphasis is on observing, exploring, asking questions and understanding. The trainer should remember to brief the participants about what they should observe and about the customs and norms that need to be respected.

Group Presentation

The participants are asked to work in groups and produce the results and findings of their group work to the members of other sub group. By this method participants get a good picture of each other's views perceptions on the topic and they are able to compare them with their own point of view. The pooling and sharing of findings enriches the discussion and learning process.

Practice Sessions

This method is of paramount importance for skill training. Participants are provided with an opportunity to practice, in controlled situation what they have learnt (that which they may have acquired through methods). It could be real life or through make-believe situation.

Games

This is a group process and includes those methods that involve usually fun-based activity, aimed at conveying feelings and experiences, which are everyday in nature, and applying them within the game being played. A game has set rules and regulations, and may or may not include a competitive element. After the game is played, it is essential that the participants be debriefed and their lessons and experiences consolidated by the trainer.

Research Activities

Trainers may require learners to undertake research activities, including online research, to gather information or further understanding about a specific subject area.

Qualifications and certified training programs

These are formal and informal learning opportunities relevant to identified need.

They are commonly provided by external educational or professional providers. Their duration varies depending on the qualification.

This also includes generic training courses, including a series of training events, offered by external training providers.

Specialised programs

This is training provided by suppliers, support industries, industry peak bodies and/or government.

Other events

The list of training events is endless, but includes:

- Conferences
- Seminars
- Meetings
- Exhibitions
- Trade presentations
- Symposiums
- Agencies.





Activity 18 - Identify learning and development opportunities

You are required to identify a range of learning and development opportunities you would use to ensure staff have the knowledge, skills and attitudes to complete the tasks required of them when implementing your project or program.



TYPE OF LEARNING AND DEVELOPMENT OPPORTUNITY	TEAM MEMBER TO UNDERTAKE TRAINING	TOPICS FOR INCLUSION IN TRAINING

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

1.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 1,2

1.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 3

1.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 4

1.4 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 5

1.5 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 6,7,8,9

1.6 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 10,11

1.7 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 12

1.8 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 13,14,15

1.9 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 16

1.10 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 17,18

1.11 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 6,7,8,9

Summary

Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project

Confirm the program/project

- Definition of terms innovative, project and program
- Aspects of project or program to confirm
- Identify types of tourism project or program
- Identify reasons for possible tourism projects or programs
- Methods to identify and clarify possible objectives
- Establish project or program objectives
- Types of objectives of tourism projects or programs

Identify factors affecting timelines for implementation

- Economic factors
- Environmental factors
- Technological factors
- Political factors
- Social factors
- Legal factors
- Competitive factors
- Contractual obligations
- Integration with other programs and projects
- Advertised timelines for availability or implementation
- Weather and seasonality factors
- Common conflict factors
- Identify feasibility for new projects and programs

Develop program/project plans

- Importance of developing tourism projects and program plans
- Activities associated with developing project and program plans
- Contents of the project / program plan

Link budget to key outcomes

- Basis for budgets
- Linking budgets to project objectives
- Types of budgets

- Key requirements for budgets
- Estimating project/program revenue
- Estimating project/program expenses
- Establish budget control and monitoring guidelines
- Expense budget controls
- Monitoring budgets

Identify monitoring and reporting arrangements**Select program/project management tools****Maintain program/project records**

- Establish monitoring and reporting arrangements
- Identify clear evaluation criteria
- Aim of monitoring project activities
- Establish reporting arrangements

Allocate resources

- Activities associated with allocating resources
- Types of capabilities
- Types of resources
- Factors affecting capabilities and resources
- Utilising community resources
- Identify tourism infrastructure inventory and tourism carrying capacity

Integrate program/plan with other initiatives

- Importance of integrating all business initiatives
- Types of integrating considerations

Confirm agreements with service providers

- Obtaining approval or support for implementation of projects or programs
- Methods to obtain approval
- Official approval funds approval
- Community approval
- Feedback
- Explore the potential for joint ventures and strategic alliances
- Confirming agreements with service suppliers

Develop contingency plans

- Introduction to contingency plans
- Importance of planning for unforeseen events
- Contingency plans for 'positive' and 'negative' situations
- Contingency plan activities
- Common contingencies to be addressed
- Contents of a contingency plan

Develop teams to support program/project implementation

- Identify team structure for projects / programs
- Develop project/program team
- Identify learning and development opportunities
- Types of learning and development opportunities

Element 2:

Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project

2.1 Allocate tasks and resources

2.6 Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation

Introduction

Once all plans, roles and responsibilities have been developed, it is vital that they are communicated to those who need to know them.

Whilst most of the communication of project plans will come from departmental managers and supervisors, staff can also communicate amongst themselves to ensure everyone understands exactly what is required and the procedures to follow to ensure the standards are met.



Once team members are aware of their expectations it is now time for the project to start. The implementation process must now commence.

Activities associated with allocating tasks and resources

Allocate tasks and resources may include:

- Complying with approved/established plans
- Modifying allocations on the basis of extra funds available
- Taking action to address changes in the operational and implementation context for the program/project
- Communicating actions taken to the appropriate team members and relevant stakeholders
- Recording actions taken
- Ensuring resource allocations align with established guidelines and accountability protocols
- Ensuring transparency of relevant decision making processes and the expenditure of funds.



Project/program implementation considerations

Planning for the implementation of activities and actions is essential to ensure all aspects relating to the proposed project or program have been considered, planned and have clear plans for implementation.

Aspects of planning that needs to take place to ensure the implementation of project or program activities are conducted in a thorough manner include but not limited to:

- Compliance requirements
- Occupational safety and health (OSH)
- Legal liability exposure
- Integration with other aspects of the business
- Timing issues
- Resources
- Changes to policies and procedures
- Documentation & record keeping
- Impact on organisational culture.



Identify predictable consequences of implementing new projects

As implementation actions takes place, things often go exactly to plan for a variety of reasons, both caused by factors within and external to the department or organisation.

Change quite often evolves from its original plan as variations and alteration take place. Quite often as change is actually implemented, further change or correction is required.

Change always brings with it a certain level of unpredictability.

Managers must understand this and be realistic in how project plans will be disturbed and what productivity levels can be achieved.

Whilst managers will not be able to predict all consequences of change, some predictable consequences of change exist.

Disruptions to routine

Without a doubt, disruptions to routine will take place. These may be caused by changes associated with the transition from old systems to new systems including changes to:

- Facilities, fixtures or fittings
- Equipment or supplies
- Organisational policies and procedures
- Management and personnel
- Training
- Job roles and responsibilities
- Work tasks
- SOP's.



These disruptions may be caused internally by management or externally through suppliers, weather, transportation, availability, laws or regulations to name a few.

Quite often when physical change to a work environment takes place, certain areas need to be closed and reconstructed with manual activities causing physical and emotional disruption and strain.

Problems with timelines

Naturally as disruptions take place, timelines are often not met. There is often a change reaction, with different activities interacting and relying on others. Flexibility in the approach to specific activities may need to be considered.

Where timelines may not be met, communication is a key requirement to let affected parties know at the earliest possible time, to enable them to make contingencies accordingly.

Issues with reporting structure

One natural reaction to change is a change to job roles and organisational structures. Not only are staff unaware of their new roles, but may be unaware as to who their managers are, or who they report to in times of uncertainty or where clarification and support is required.

It is vital clear lines of accountability; reporting and communication are identified and explained to staff.

Extra support required by employees

As mentioned, during these trying times, managers must be empathic to the conditions and stresses staff are confronted with. They must show tolerance and have realistic expectation on how staff will behave and the level of productivity that will take place.

Communicating project/program

Now that the project team structure has been identified, it is now time to notify team members of what the project encompasses and their responsibilities and tasks.

One of the key aims of communicating project information is to detail how it will affect team members and other stakeholders, either as a collective or individually.

Following are some areas that need to be explained to project team members in relation to the project/program as a whole.

Firstly it is essential project team members have an understanding of the overall project.

They must understand, at a minimum:

- The nature of the project/program
- Purpose of the project/program
- Background information resulting in the creation of the project/program
- Objectives of the project/program
- Overall implementation strategy
- Outline of the project/program activities
- Timelines for completion



- Communication channels
- Project expectations.

Communicating project/program responsibilities and tasks

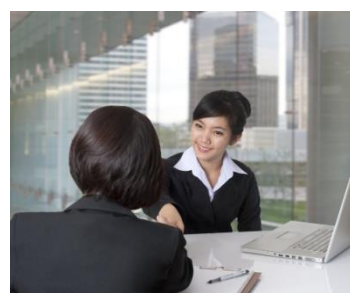
It is important that everyone knows what is expected of them. When new strategies are to be implemented everyone must be aware of the roles each person plays.

Depending on the role of each staff member within the implementation process, they must be made aware of what is expected of them. This includes a detailed understanding of their roles and responsibilities including:

- Structure of the project time
- Level of responsibility and authority
- Start dates of change
- Expected completion date
- Pre-change activities including attending meetings, reading job descriptions etc.
- Activities to be performed
- Resources required to implement the plan
- Work breakdown
- Involvement of other staff
- Training to be taken
- Support mechanisms
- Expected standard of performance
- Milestones for completion
- Budgets to work within
- Methods of communication
- Making observations
- Providing feedback.



By having clear roles and responsibilities, it helps to eliminate confusion of what each person is to do.



Methods to communicate project and roles

The communication of new project or program information may occur in various ways.

The key to communicating this information is the communication must be planned.

This is especially true when explaining new activities and initiatives that are unfamiliar to project staff, as they are the stakeholders who will be impacted the most.

Your approach should follow these guidelines:

- Hold a formal staff meeting to inform stakeholders of the project plan and expectations – if they have been actively involved in the development process then the concept should not come as anything new to them
- Using small group information sessions
- Disseminating via computerised communications
- Making verbal presentations and explanations
- Providing the strategies through in-house publications
- Remember it is important not only to explain the purpose of the project strategies but also explain why it will be beneficial
- Give them a hard copy of the new project plans and strategies, either in its entirety or the parts specific to the stakeholder– give them everything that is applicable to their area such as:
 - Copies of plans
 - Copies of standards
 - Copies of policies
 - Copies of procedures
- Explain the changes – tell them how the ‘new’ project differs from existing operations. Be specific
- Tell them about the dates for introducing the new project implementation
- Reassure them they are not required to implement the changes ‘tomorrow’
- Inform of the training being provided to support implementation of the new project requirements – let them know when and where the training is happening, what it will involve, who will be leading it
- Encourage questions about the project strategies – answer them fully and honestly
- Make yourself available outside this meeting to talk to if they have concerns regarding the project strategies
- Include new policies, procedures etc. in operational manuals, induction programs and in-house training.





Activity 19 – Communicate project strategies

Briefly describe how you will communicate the project strategies you identified for implementation in your business in a timely manner.



Manage project implementation

As mentioned, now that all the planning for projects and programs has been completed, with initial planning considerations thought through and team members aware of their responsibilities it is not time to implement the project.

The activities associated with managing project implementation may include:

- Refining project plans
- Consulting with steering committees and other relevant stakeholders
- Initiating and operating identified systems, procedures, processes, practices and policies
- Facilitating operational and implementation understanding regarding the program/project
- Ensuring the requirements of all relevant plans are implemented as required or amended on the basis of feedback received and issues arising
- Providing leadership and direction to team members
- Responding appropriately to established system triggers as operational demands dictate
- Soliciting input and feedback from team members and relevant stakeholders
- Resolving disputes and disagreements relating to program/project implementation
- Negotiating program/project change proposals throughout the life of the initiative
- Apply consulting and reporting mechanisms.



Identify support and resources required to support implementation of new project/program strategies

Any time change takes place resulting from the implementation of new projects or programs, whilst in the long term it will benefit the organisation and staff involved, it will cause disruptions and make activities harder for staff in the short term.

This is evident not only as the actual change takes place, but as staff try to understand and become familiar with the new way of doing things.

It is especially important that during this stressful time, that management play an active role in leading and supporting the team as a whole and individuals who may need assistance.

There are many ways a manager can provide assistance and support, however at the end of the day, the aim is to enable staff to be able to learn and implement new changes into the workplace.

During this period, you must manage the twin functions of 'group task' and 'group maintenance'.



Task functions

'Task' functions of leadership involve leading the group successfully understanding and performing new activities associated with change. Factors included here are:

- Setting plans to help staff achieve the set change goals
- Passing on facts and skills
- Offering ideas and information
- Seeking opinions
- Giving directions
- Getting the individuals within a group to function as a cohesive unit
- Coordinating activities
- Clarifying goals as they progress through the change process.



Maintenance functions

'Maintenance' functions centre on ensuring that staff continue to work harmoniously and that there are good working relationships among the team. This includes your being involved in:

- Provision of positive feedback to staff – to help keep them interested, engaged and motivated
- Giving encouragement – either verbally or non-verbally
- Raising enthusiasm amongst the team – to make them aware that they can achieve what is required, and to provide motivation during the tough times when they might be tired, frustrated or disinterested



- Maintaining a safe, secure and supportive physical and emotional environment – physical safety is, of course, important, but so, too, is the need to provide emotional support when staff find the going tough or when they feel dispirited
- Acknowledging contributions and efforts made by staff – the important thing is to provide acknowledgement for effort and not just for success
- Using humour as a motivator and means of reducing tension – this can assist in maintaining momentum and getting staff to have another go at something they may have previously not succeeded in
- Sensitive and non-judgemental communication – it is very important that whatever is said to staff cannot be misconstrued in any way. Your role is to support, encourage, nurture – not to criticise or put people down
- Frequent, accurate and encouraging feedback – which means finding something to provide a positive comment about even when staff are unable to achieve the set objective
- Allowing staff to make mistakes and create an environment where it's okay to do so.



Activity 20 – Identify key project implementation considerations

Briefly describe the key considerations that you would focus on when implementing your project or program.

2.2 Maintain financial control systems

Introduction

It is essential that project managers are able to manage the financial aspects of a project or program.

If a new program is part of a larger organisation, there is a team of managers and staff with a wide range of skills and knowledge available to solve problems, prepare budgets, analyse and interpret financial information and mentor new staff.

If a project or program is deemed 'its own separate entity' project managers will need to undertake many or all of these functions, be able to monitor and understand the financial aspects and responsibilities of the project or program as well as take any corrective action.



Focus of financial management

From a financial perspective, the project manager must attempt to use finances and resources in an effective and efficient manner.

Depending on whether the project or program generates revenue or is a 'cost only' exercise, successful financial management can be achieved by making decisions about:

- Profitability - generating sales, controlling costs and expenses
- Liquidity - managing cash flows and maintaining sufficient cash reserves.

For a project to remain stable and cost effective, financial managers must monitor cash flow and control costs and expenses carefully. In successful projects the managers themselves must have a sound understanding of the principles of financial management and participate in applying them

Financial management procedures and processes

Financial management involves the following procedures and processes:

- Book-keeping - recording daily financial data
- Reporting - using book-keeping records to produce Statements of Financial Performance, Financial Position and Cash Flows
- Analysing and interpreting the reports - so as to identify and overcome problems, and effectively plan and control project operations in the future.



It is essential to closely monitor and control the following:

- Sales, costs and profit
- Internal control
- Pricing decisions
- Cash flow
- Performance compared with budget
- Stability – short term and long term.

Importance of financial control systems

Financial control is the system of “checks and balances” management use to:

- Ensure the security of assets
- Control costs
- Increase sales revenue
- Maximise profitability.



There are two main requirements for effective and efficient financial control:

1. Methods and procedures for various job categories need to be documented, understood and followed in order to achieve operational efficiency, and to protect assets from waste, theft or fraud
2. Forms and reports should be easy to read and satisfactorily provide the required information. They measure efficiency and effectiveness and provide information to be analysed in order to identify problem areas.

This information must be:

- Accurate
- Timely
- Useful
- Cost-effective in preparation.

Financial control activities

Maintain financial control systems may include:

- Entering data into established budgets
- Approving expenditures
- Obtaining necessary quotations for expenses over a designated amount
- Verifying purchases, payments and products/services received
- Auditing the books
- Ensuring budgetary controls and guidelines are being met.

Principles of a good financial control system

The basic principles of a good financial control system include:

- **Establish preventative procedures** e.g., establish controls to prevent or minimise theft.
Prevention is preferable to capturing the culprits after the event
- **Management supervision is required.** There is a need for constant monitoring and observation. Temptation is possible if the staff believe that management is non-observant
- **Monitor and update systems.** Systems should be flexible so that they can be updated or changed e.g., there is no point to staff completing forms if they are not read, and any actions indicated by them put into place. Also, systems need regular revision and modification
- **Use employee selection and training systems.** Care needs to be taken when recruiting staff to ensure that they are suitable and have the skills and knowledge as well as personal attributes that are required by the organisation
- **Establish responsibilities.** A job description showing the list of duties, areas of responsibilities and tasks needs to be clearly defined, preferably in writing. This ensures staff accountability and avoids ambiguity
- **Prepare written procedures** so that employees are aware of company policy and procedures
- **Maintain adequate records.** The complexity of documentation will depend on the size of the project or program, but in all instances clearly designed and completed records assist staff to organise their work
- **Meet relevant statutory requirements.** Systems should easily provide sufficient and accurate data upon request from statutory organisations
- **Separate record-keeping and control of assets.** It is advisable to have more than one person involved in some tasks e.g., recording monies received. Also it is preferable not to have the same person receiving monies and banking it, or paying accounts. Separation of duties maintains honesty, and prevents collusion



- **Limit staff access to assets** e.g., cash and inventory. Do not involve more people than necessary to limit the exposure to temptation
- **Conduct surprise checks** by a person who is not involved in that area. This will also prevent collusion
- **Divide the responsibility for related transactions.** In this way, one person may verify the work of another. This should also prevent errors occurring
- **Rotating jobs also reduces collusion.** It helps prevent theft as well as widening staff skills and knowledge base
- **Insist on mandatory vacations.** Ensure staff take their vacations regularly. Fraud has frequently been found when someone has been forced to take leave after a number of years in one position and no holidays have been taken
- **Explain the reasons so those carrying out control functions** can understand why they are completing the checks and balances
- **Use machines and technology** to reduce possibilities of theft and fraud – any losses will be highlighted against a regular physical stock-take
- **Set standards and evaluate results.** The organisation should have benchmarks of what is “normal” for their organisation. Regularly compare and monitor results
- **Design forms and reports specific to the business.** These can be written or computerised. Reports should regularly compare actuals against budgets and any variations should be investigated
- **Control misuse of documents** by having sequential numbering on all relevant financial documents e.g., purchase orders, invoices, receipts and cheques
- **Have an audit trail.** Most computerised accounting packages have a clear, password protected audit trail for all transactions. Authority to make any changes lies with senior management
- **Supervise the system and conduct reviews** by having constant monitoring and supervision. Internal auditing is recommended
- **Conduct external audits.** This is normal practice in large organisations and highlights errors in record keeping as well theft.



Control of project/program purchases

It is best to divide the responsibilities for purchasing among several individuals when buying for a project or program. Co-ordination over the various purchasing tasks is achieved using four basic documents:

- Purchase requisition form
- Order form
- Invoice
- Receiving report, to which is attached the delivery note.



Modern technology has had significant impact on the purchase and acquisition of products in today's business. Orders are now often placed using email and it is possible to use electronic systems to conduct the entire process from automatic ordering to final payment to supplier without human intervention.

Control of financial records

It is not enough simply to establish the records, systems etc. – they have to be used.

Your checks should verify the established records are being accurately maintained as required, which is commonly on a daily basis.

It is essential any record keeping system used enables easy access to required materials, files, data and information: the system must be user-friendly.

The intention must be the record keeping can provide information etc. whenever it is required by management - who may require this data as a management tool.

In short, daily records must be kept, maintained, up-dated daily.

Regular scheduled audits will help achieve as will un-announced ‘spot checks’.

A critical aspect of managing financial controls that are in place is the need to monitor the implementation of the accounting system.

Monitoring activities

Monitoring activities which may be employed can include:

- Ensuring compliance with accounting policies and procedures
- Ensuring accuracy and completeness in entries and records
- Ensuring regular review and up-date of accounting policies and procedures
- Ensuring daily records are maintained
- Ensuring financial records are maintained
- Ensuring the security of all assets and accounting records
- Monitoring financing facilities.



Activity 21 – Identify financial controls

You are required to write a short outline of the processes you can use to maintain financial control for your proposed project or program

Take remedial action to address financial control problems

As discussed in Section 1.4, budgeting is a tool used by managers to forecast future projected operations. Setting a budget makes management more aware of the project goals, their potential and costs.

Also, once project managers have set their budgets for the next period, they will be able to compare their results at the end of that financial period. The budget therefore operates as an internal financial control process.

By being able to spot large variances between what you planned for and what occurred, and by being able to spot areas of concern that may lead you to discover:

- Areas of low performance
- Over spending
- Inefficiency
- Theft
- Fraud
- Embezzlement
- Error.



When a variance occurs, investigate the reasons and revise plans. This revision will allow you to make more accurate budgets for the future.

2.3 Monitor program/project progress

Introduction

The key to monitoring the progress of project or program strategies is to be proactive. You should actively seek to monitor the effectiveness of the implementation of project or program strategies as opposed to simply passively receiving whatever progress reports happen to come your way.

Physically go and talk to people, make sure those involved notice you taking an interest and know you are reviewing progress.

This section will explore the importance of monitoring and techniques that can be used to monitor the performance of project or program initiatives and activities.



Definition of monitoring

Monitoring is a process of determining how well our project or program plans are being implemented.

You cannot monitor something if you don't have a plan or basic structure of how something should be done, or a defined goal or target.

Importance of monitoring project performance

There are good reasons to monitor project

The benefits are:

- Things are more likely to happen as planned
- Management and staff actually know what's going on in the progression of program or project
- Problems are identified and corrected
- Activities are consistent over time
- Project operations fit with objectives
- Team members feel supported and involved
- Stakeholder needs are met.



Need for monitoring project performance

Generic need to monitor implementation will relate to:

- Keeping promises made – about the monitoring in relation to:
 - Type of monitoring which will occur
 - Frequency or duration of monitoring
 - Persons who will be involved
 - How data will be recorded
 - Nature of the information to be captured



The exact need for monitoring will often depend on:

- The individual project which has been implemented – in terms of:
 - Scope of the program
 - Activities involved
 - Objectives
- The activities within the project – which has been developed for the project and which may require nominated activities
- The stakeholders who will be:
 - Involved in delivering aspects of the program
 - Impacted by initiatives
- The areas – the initiatives are expected to affect, in terms of:
 - Environmental factors and impact
 - Use of facilities, public spaces, buildings and infrastructure
 - Traffic - pedestrian and vehicle patterns and flow
- Gathering data – so it can be used to:
 - Review results
 - Analyse progress and outcomes so the project can be objectively evaluated
 - Determine changes, if any, which may need to be made
 - Identify the potential for any future programs
 - Justify expenditure in the program
- Involving the local community – in relation to:
 - Including them in the processes required in capturing information
 - Ensuring they notice the monitoring taking place – so they know it is occurring



- Keeping the public aware of what is taking place – through a variety of approaches such as:
 - Public meetings and reporting presentations
 - Postings on the designated website and social media
 - Media releases and media interviews.

Areas of project or program to monitor

There are many areas of a project that can be monitored including, but not limited to:

These operations can include:

- Achievement of project objectives
- Relevance of original objectives against changing industry and customer needs and trends
- Feedback from stakeholders
- The procedures or systems
- The workflow
- Whether or not there are gaps or overlaps in activities or resources used
- The workload of team members
- The time it takes to undertake activities
- Completion of individual timelines
- Costs associated with project or program
- Involvement from stakeholders
- Impact on environment or local community
- Level of stakeholder satisfaction with the project or program initiatives provided.



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Steps of monitoring project /program activities

In essence the steps associated with monitoring projects and programs included:

Work out what needs to be evaluated

Not everything can or should be monitored all the time.

Some things will have been recently reviewed and are progressing well. Some systems generated reports will show that goals are being achieved according to plan and therefore no further investigation is required.

Generally, things to be monitored include:

- Areas showing early warning signs things are not going according to plan
- Areas of critical activity to the organisation – high revenue raising streams, areas subject to intense legal scrutiny
- Areas due for scheduled review.



Select monitoring methods

The methods chosen for monitoring performance are generally built into the planning process. It is a good idea when planning to keep in mind the reporting on the success or otherwise of goals. It is frustrating to set a goal but not be able to say whether or not it has been achieved.

There are many tools or methods available to monitor progress or outcomes of work operations.

Some examples are:

This is where you decide how to measure your progress including:

- Reading and analysing information sourced – including legislation, industry data and reports, best practice information, new market research information, revised internal policies and procedures
- Reports – statistical, financial, written or verbal
- Obtaining customer feedback – verbal or written, individual or focus groups, structured or unstructured in format
- Using a pretend customer – getting someone to pretend to be a customer in your premises and then critically feeding back what it was like, what could be improved etc.
- Walking about observing what takes place and how it could be improved, what could be improved
- Use of checklists to tick off whether or not required performance points are being adhered to by project team members
- Brainstorming sessions where project team members are asked to contribute any thoughts or ideas they may have about improving a particular aspect of service, or about introducing a new initiative
- Project team members input and review – obtaining ‘grass roots’ input to potential and actual problems, and asking those directly concerned about how the situation can be resolved
- Checking of documentation - including budgets and reports
- Interviews with stakeholders
- Surveys
- Focus group interviews
- Discuss progress
- Solicited and unsolicited feedback
- Research on existing projects
- Organisational reviews
- Workforce management data
- Statistical data
- Comparisons with Key performance indicators



- Surveys
- Flowcharts
- Benchmarking
- Verifying time sheets
- Gap analysis
- Compliance reports.

Professional monitoring tools

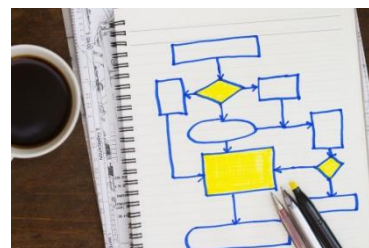
Tools that may be used to examine project performance issues may include:

QC 7 Tools

- Cause and Effect Analysis
- Flow Chart Check Sheet
- Control Charts.

Management and Planning Tools

- Root Cause Analysis
- Plan-Do-Check-Action (PDCA)
- Priorities Matrix
- Process Decision
- Activity Network Diagram
- Affinity Diagram
- Matrix Diagram
- Program Chart.



Tree Diagram Problem Solving Models

- Five Whys
- Process Improvement Models.

RATER model

This model consists of the following areas that customers generally consider to be important when they use a service:

- Reliability – ability to provide the service promised consistently, accurately, and on time
- Assurance – the knowledge, skills, and credibility of staff; and their ability to use this expertise to inspire trust and confidence
- Tangibles – the physical evidence of the service provided. This could be offices, equipment, employees and the communication and marketing materials that are used
- Empathy – the relationship between employees and customers
- Responsiveness – ability to provide quick, high quality service to customers.



Activity 22 – Identify and compare monitoring methods

Briefly describe the monitoring methods you would use to evaluate the success of your project or program. Describe the advantages of using these methods.

MONITORING METHOD	ADVANTAGES OF MONITORING METHOD

Compare what is happening with what should be happening

Here you review and analyse what's actually happening against some benchmark.

Quite simply this includes:

- Comparing actual performance against key performance indicators - see below
- Comparing actual performance against benchmark indicators, which can include industry indicators or performance levels of other projects.



Organisation's key performance indicators

Organisation's key performance indicators are a set of metrics which organisations can use to measure their performance of projects and programs.

Whilst KPI's have been identified earlier in this manual, some of these specific to monitoring projects can include:

- Achievement of project objectives
- Achievement of key project activities or milestones
- Adherence to budget
- Adherence to timelines.

Take appropriate action

This involves making the necessary adjustments to activities, tasks and responsibilities to name but a few possible changes.

Depending on what is being monitored, involving project team members in all or some stages of the monitoring process is likely to achieve better results.



Monitoring project team member performance

Whilst it is important to monitor the project itself, it is still important to monitor the performance of individual team members.

The activities associated with monitoring team member performance may involve:

- Review and update team objectives on an ongoing basis in consultation with the team
- Review project deliverables developed by project team specifications
- Monitor delivery of key deliverables to check that they adhere to agreed dates
- Provide feedback on team progress to team members
- Review training sessions to track outcomes
- Refine training agenda in accordance with changing needs
- Encourage feedback sessions from team members.

Performance measures may include:

- Improved individual participation in team dialogues
- Productivity
- Staff morale, work ethic and work satisfaction
- Percentage of chargeable hours /days per week
- Performance of key activities.



Obtain feedback from key stakeholders

We have seen 'customer-focus' is critical to any successful project.

On a regular basis it is important to review stakeholder satisfaction with your project performance.

Where there is some 'emergency' in relation to project deficiencies such as frequent and animated complaints or delays, reviews should be more regular.

This should be done, as far as possible, using verifiable data, rather than relying on subjective impressions and hearsay from other project team members.

To obtain the information on which to base our customer-focus we need to:

- Undertake research
- Actively ask for feedback from stakeholders who have experienced the project outcomes or involved in its implementation.



The critical thing about this feedback is it must be fed back to be incorporated into future plans and standards.

Objectives of collecting and reviewing stakeholder feedback

Reviews of customer service strategies should seek to achieve the following objectives:

- Identify the extent to which project stakeholders and others are satisfied (or not) with the outcomes
- Identify the areas in which there is satisfaction (or not) with project delivery
- Identify the precise nature of any dissatisfaction. It may be with product, services, facilities, timing, access or information
- Identify the team members involved in both superior and inferior outputs
- Identify if there is a certain time of the day/week when outputs are reduced or at their best
- Discover what can be done to improve a less than optimum situation
- Identify what needs to be done to maintain the present satisfactory level of delivery.



It is especially important to look for trends – one-off complaints or dissatisfaction may not be indicative of anything whereas a series of complaints is likely to be more instructive.

Identify types of problems requiring corrective actions

The types of problems that may arise in project implementation but common problems may relate to:

- Product or service failures
- Long delays
- Escalating costs
- Inability to achieve objectives
- Government interference
- Competitor interference
- Inaccurate or conflicting information provided to stakeholders
- Lack of resources required to implement projects
- Resource constraints
- Conflicts in priorities
- Lack of information
- Supplier delays
- Differences in opinion
- Interpersonal conflict
- Hazardous events
- Time constraints
- Electricity shortages
- Bad weather
- Shortfalls in expected outcomes
- Poor personnel performance.



Initiate corrective action

Corrective actions taken within a project can be seen as either short term action or long term action.

Where output is paramount, it is sometimes necessary to take short term action to solve a problem until it can be looked at more closely and the problem dealt with more thoroughly.

Short term corrective action

Reasons for this include:

- Pressure of work often means there just isn't time to stop and analyse the problem more carefully and in more detail
- To provide the necessary or expected services to the customer



- To meet OSH requirements
- To deal with a complaint
- To get team members working together again
- To give you time to analyse and work through the problem at a later date.

Usually these stop-gap measures are not satisfactory in the long term as they are often more costly and they do not prevent the problem from recurring.

As the manager of an area, it is important you consciously decide when to take short term action and when this would be inappropriate.

If you decide to take the short term approach, then it is a good idea to:

- Make a definite time to look at it more thoroughly later on and to decide who to involve in further problem solving
- Inform staff and management it is a short term solution which will be dealt with more thoroughly at a specified time
- Cost the implications of tackling the problem this way.



Long-term corrective action

There may be a number of corrective changes to be made including, but certainly not limited to:

Management changes

- New management
- Change in orientation to service
- Setting of some new directions in relation to several other factors
- New management focus.



Organisational re-structures

- Change of personnel structure
- Elimination of positions
- New job roles
- Changes in job roles
- New knowledge or skills.

Introduction of new equipment

New equipment means:

- Possible interruptions to operations for installation
- Training for staff
- Requires that staff can explain the new equipment to customers
- Changes in job roles
- Changes in procedures or workflow.



Recruitment practices

- Need to establish comprehensive job descriptions and job specifications
- Seeking of new knowledge and skills
- Change advertising strategy
- Revised interviewing and selection process
- Revised selection criteria.



Activity 23 – Identify possible problems and corrective actions

Briefly describe some possible problems that you can envisage may take place during the implementation of your project or program. Also, identify corrective actions you may take to minimise or eliminate these problems.

POSSIBLE PROBLEMS	POSSIBLE CORRECTIVE ACTION

2.4 Report program/project progress

Introduction

A critical aspect of auditing the success of a project to date is to ensure the identified reports are produced and made available on the basis identified as being necessary for that project.

Periodically, there will be a need for you to provide your team and management with feedback in regard to achievement or non-achievement of project or program initiatives.

This feedback must:

- Be fair and accurate
- Be based on facts
- Not be personal in nature.

This will normally include making recommendations to management or a board for variations to project strategic and operational plans.

Every manager or owner will have preferences regarding what they use and rely on regarding project reports but there is consistency of need to ensure that the appropriate systems to support their production are in place.

This section identifies checks to ensure an appropriate reporting system is established and used.



Primary project reporting requirements

The primary requirements that need to be achieved when preparing project progress reports include:

- The necessary reports are being produced
- These reports are being produced when required
- The reports are being sent to all the required people.

Basic checks to ensure an effective reporting system

The basic checks to ensure an appropriate reporting system is established include verifying:

- The schedules for generation of project reports are established and being complied with
- The names of the projects reports required are identified
- The personnel who should generate these reports are identified
- The people to whom the reports are distributed are identified
- The method of distribution of the project reports is identified
- The personnel who must analyse the identified project reports are nominated
- Appropriate action is being taken to address deficiencies etc. as identified from report analysis.



Ensure reliability of reports

To ensure the reliability of reporting procedures you should check:

- The reports are being produce in accordance with the identified reporting schedule
- The required people are receiving the reports
- The reports are accurate
- The reports enable a true understanding of the progress of the project
- The reports are in-line with the required report formats
- The internal people who receive the reports are able to read and interpret these reports.

Report schedules

Some businesses will prepare a formal written schedule setting out the names of reports to be prepared, and the frequency with which they must be produced.

Common schedules are:

- Daily
- Weekly
- Monthly
- Quarterly
- Annually.

These timelines will be set to make sure management has access, on the basis deemed necessary, to make the most appropriate and effective use of the data applicable to the project, and to comply with any externally imposed legal obligations that might apply.

The checks to ensure financial reports are produced as required include:

- Visually sighting each report at the designated time – as opposed to relying on verbal feedback they have been prepared
- Confirming your visual sighting of the reports with others
- Enquiring to see if those who receive the reports want those reports to be provided on a more frequent basis
- Researching to determine if additional types of reports need to be produced – to help managers achieve its project goals, objectives and targets.



Distribution of reports

The forwarding of the reports may simply entail leaving a hard copy of reports in the in-tray for each department or manager. In many businesses, e-mail may be used.

In some cases, the distribution of progress reports may need to be sent to a wider audience of project stakeholders, whom may have a financial or other vested interest in the success of the project or program.

Each project will have its own list and schedule for the distribution of reports.

Commonly, these project reports do not have as wide a circulation as other operations reports, and possible recipients include:

- Managers
- Owners and partners
- Investors in the project
- Accounts department
- Local government
- Local community
- Banks.



Activities associated with reporting project progress

Report program/project progress may include:

- Supporting reports with fact-based evidence
- Preparing written reports
- Providing verbal presentation and explanations
- Organising meetings with relevant stakeholders.

Methods to sharing project progress

Share performance related information may include:

- Holding team meetings
- Providing hard copy information
- Sharing information via the intranet
- Disseminating information at staff briefings.





Activity 24 - Sharing project progress information

Briefly explain how you intend, on a regular basis, to advise your stakeholders (internal and external) of the progress of your project or program.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

2.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 19,20

2.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 21

2.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 22,23

2.4 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 24

2.5 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 6,7,8,9

2.6 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 19,20
-

Summary

Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project

Allocate tasks and resources

Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation

- Activities associated with allocating tasks and resources
- Project/program implementation considerations
- Identify predictable consequences of change
- Communicating project/program
- Communicating project/program responsibilities and tasks
- Methods to communicate project and roles
- Manage project implementation
- Identify support and resources required to support implementation of new project/program strategies

Maintain financial control systems

- Focus of financial management
- Financial management procedures and processes
- Importance of financial control systems
- Financial control activities
- Principles of a good financial control system
- Control of project/program purchases
- Control of financial records
- Take remedial action to address financial control problems

Monitor program/project progress

- Definition of monitoring
- Importance of monitoring project performance
- Need for monitoring project performance
- Areas of project or program to monitor
- Steps of monitoring project /program activities
- Monitoring project team member performance
- Obtain feedback from key stakeholders
- Identify types of problems requiring corrective actions
- Initiate corrective action

Report program/project progress

- Primary project reporting requirements
- Basic checks to ensure an effective reporting system
- Ensure reliability of reports
- Report schedules
- Distribution of reports
- Activities associated with reporting project progress
- Methods to sharing project progress

Element 3:

Finalise the innovative tourism program/project

3.1 Administer winding up activities for the program/project

Introduction

Quite often a tourism project or program is considered a separate entity to the rest of the tourism operations and hence will cease once the initial objectives have been achieved.

If the project or program has been a success it may be expanded upon, varied or incorporated into a key element of normal operations.

But what happens when the project comes to a conclusion? What are the steps involved in finalising and 'winding up' a project?



In this section we will explore some of the activities associated with closing a project and the administrative tasks that need to be performed.

Types of project/program finalisation activities

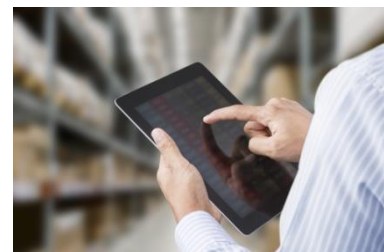
Whilst the types of wind up activities will vary depending on the nature of each specific project or program, there are a number of common wind-up activities that will be completed.

It is quite common for a project manager to complete a range of activities at the completion of a project or program. There is generally an urgency associated with this as the organisation will commonly seek to finalise all aspects as soon as possible.

These will be explained in more detail below.

Activities to complete include:

- **Inspection of the program/project deliverables**
 - Allocate inspection times
 - Ensure all deliverables have been completed
 - Identify the status of uncompleted deliverables
 - Identify reasons for incompletion of deliverables
 - Identify timeline and future actions to ensure uncompleted deliverables are completed



- **Testing operational capacity of the program/project deliverables**
 - Ensure all aspects of products and services provided are operating as promised
 - Identify and explain post-projects services to stakeholders
 - Explain your involvement in project activities
 - Ensure all necessary manuals, SOP's or supportive documents are prepared to ensure post-project activities can be conducted to desired quality
 - Provide training to others whom are now in charge of post-project activities
- **Evaluating the program/project deliverables against set criteria**
 - Schedule evaluation team
 - Identify evaluation criteria
 - Identify evaluation techniques
 - Conduct evaluation
 - Prepare evaluation documentation
- **Obtaining sign off on nominated aspects of the program/project**
 - Where products and services have been provided, authorisation or hand over of items must be 'signed off' by stakeholders
 - Prepare 'transfer of ownership' of items prepared for others
 - Ensure insurance matters have been finalised
- **Collecting feedback from stakeholders**
 - Collecting feedback forms
 - Conduct team member de-briefing sessions
 - Conduct final management meetings to review project or program
- **Finalising revenues promised to support the program/project**
 - Receiving final payment of the client's account in accordance with the terms and conditions set out in contract
 - Processing payment and posting payment record on account
 - Issuing receipt and 'Thank you' letter to customers
 - Ensuring all revenues are allocated to the correct budget line items
- **Finalising payments related to program/project expenditure**
 - Paying out all final payments outstanding to suppliers and external contractors
 - Processing commissions where applicable
 - Signing off personnel time sheets – and ensuring all hours claimed by staff have been authorised
 - Paying team members



- **Re-allocation of project team staff**
 - Finalise project contracts
 - Re-allocate project staff where applicable
 - Amend staff contracts to reflect employment changes
- **Finalise accounting documentation**
 - Finalising all financial documentation including closure of accounts and printing of final accounts and payments
 - Preparing final financial reports and statements
 - Distributing final profits to stakeholders
 - Closing accounts where required
 - Storing the account file in an appropriate storage folder or area
- **Undertaking internal and/or external auditing**
 - Select auditing team
 - Identify areas for auditing
 - Conduct audit activities
- **Undertaking formal reporting procedures**
 - Identify final reports for completion
 - Identify reporting criteria for each report
 - Identify personnel to prepare reports
 - Distribute and present reports to stakeholders
- **Promotion of project**
 - Notify media of completion of project, success stories and benefits of project to community
 - Update websites, intranets and social media
 - Adding photos taken onto a database to be used as a marketing tool
- **Dismantling of project offices**
 - Store all documents and files accordingly
 - Finalise any leases or rental of offices and equipment
 - Re-distribute unused equipment and resources
 - Clean empty offices
 - Arrange repairs and/or sale of equipment or resources
 - Reallocate spaces to other operational departments.



As can be seen in this section there are many activities that need to be completed at the end of a project or program.

By developing a checklist, it helps to ensure that all aspects of finalising a project are not forgotten.



Activity 25 - Identify 'wind up' activities to finalise your project or program

Briefly explain the final 'wind up' activities you would need to undertake at the conclusion of your project or program.

TYPE OF WIND UP ACTIVITY	TASKS / KEY POINTS OF ACTIVITY

3.2 Review program/project administration

Introduction

In Section 2.3 of this manual, the process of monitoring business activities has been discussed.

Whether the project has finished or will be continued, at some stage a review needs to take place to determine the success of the project or program and what changes can be made to improve the success of future projects or programs.

Therefore management must review the performance of all activities that contributed to the implementation of project strategies.

It is important that project strategies and performance are reviewed on a regular basis, not just at the end of a project or program.

In the natural evolution of project activities, changes to project objectives, strategies and activities will need to take place to reflect changes in operations and direction.

If you have developed clear measurable objectives and performance criteria, the reviewing and evaluation process need not be an overly difficult or time-consuming exercise.



It is essential reviews and evaluations are scheduled at an agreed time or stage, as to answer the following questions:

- Are we on track?
- Have we achieved what we planned?
- Are any variations acceptable, or do they require action?
- Were the original objectives realistic and achievable?
- Have we improved our strategic planning ability through these actions?

The methods chosen for reviewing and evaluate the implementation and performance of project or program strategies are generally built into the planning process. It is a good idea when planning to keep in mind the reporting on the success or otherwise of objectives. It is frustrating to set an objective but not be able to say whether or not it has been achieved.

These methods can:

- Identify problems
- Help resolve problems
- Provide guidance.



Activities associated with reviewing project/program administration

Review program/project administration may include:

- Reviewing the documentation that was used
- Reviewing the systems and procedures developed
- Reviewing the command, control and communication structure
- Reviewing the input, contribution, cooperation and collaboration received from joint partners and contracted service providers.

Timing of project/program reviews

Whilst the frequency of project or program reviews will vary depending on the type of organisation and requirements by management, however they may be based on:

- Quarterly reviews
- At the end of key activities
- Scheduled project milestones
- Performance reports
- Major events triggering a review, e.g. Change in market-place
- At the conclusion of a project / program.



Activity 26 – Identify timelines for project/program reviews

Draw up a timetable that shows how frequently you will review the success of your project or program.

3.3 Evaluate the program/project

Introduction

Once the review of the project or program has taken place, it is important to evaluate the success of the project or program.

This activity is essential as it looks in detail, at all aspects of the project or program and identifies the areas of success or failure.

Difference between reviewing and evaluating success of project / program

In the previous section we looked at the process of 'reviewing' a project or program, whilst in this section we are focusing on 'evaluating' a project or program.

- What is the difference between these two activities?
- What is the focus of each of these activities?



Activity 27 – Identify difference between 'reviewing' and 'evaluating' project/program performance

In your own works answer the following questions:

1) What is the difference between these two activities?

2) What is the focus of each of these activities?

Aims of evaluating success of project / program

Aims of evaluating success of a project or program include:

- Identify the actual progress against original project objectives
- Identify the overall success of the project or program
- Identifying areas which are being done well and rewarding accordingly
- Identifying where areas where the project or future projects can be improved through:
 - Identification of problems
 - Understanding the cause
 - Finding suitable solutions
 - Selecting the correct solution
 - Implementing and monitoring the solution
- Identify the need for the project to continue, it is current or varied form
- The impact and value the project or program has provided.



Evaluation activities

In essence the activities associated with evaluating project success includes, but not limited to:

- Assessing performance against the attainment of established indicators, including objectives, use of resources, timelines, execution of allocated responsibilities and budgets
- Evaluating the outcomes of the program/project
- Evaluating the contribution made by sub-systems that supported the development and implementation phases
- Identifying lessons for inclusion in subsequent management and monitoring activities relating to innovative tourism programs/projects
- Evaluating the potential for additional/follow-on innovative tourism programs/projects
- Seeking opinions from relevant stakeholders
- Validating conclusions reached in relation to strategy performance.



[illegible]

3.4 Report on program/project administration and results

Introduction

In Section 2.4 of this manual, the process of reporting project performance based on monitoring that has taken place, has been explained in detail.

In essence, the process of reporting on the success of a project or program resulting from the monitoring process will not vary to the report to be completed at the conclusion of a project or program.

Please refer to Section 2.4 to review reporting processes and procedures.

In this section we will focus of explaining performance related information and recommendations that can be provided for future project success.

Explaining project performance related information

There are many pieces of information that may be presented including, but not limited to:

- Explaining if your project strategy and effort work
- Identifying the reasons why they work or not work
- Significant variations and the factors associated with the changes
- Unusual results and determine their causes
- Strengths and marketing opportunities
- Weaknesses and potential areas of improvement
- Impact / implications of the results and conclusions on performance.



Present recommendations for variation to project plans

As part of your review, you will need to occasionally make recommendations to management or stakeholders for variations to project plans.

Reasons for recommendations

These recommendations will usually be on the basis of:

- Project is not achieving results
- Project is obsolete or not a priority
- Unsatisfactory performance – basically, expenses being too high or income being too low
- A business opportunity – such as the opportunity to capitalise on some significant occurrence, new idea or emerging trend
- Stakeholder feedback – demanding the introduction, elimination or modification of some service or facility
- Significant alteration to systems or activities – this may be caused by some accident, emergency or an unanticipated event that has caused major disruptions to the normal way of trading.



Steps associated with making recommendations

Whilst every organisation will have their own steps, policies and procedures for making recommendations, common steps include, but not limited to:

- Targeting recommendations to evidence-based outcomes
- Reviewing internal and external business environment factors
- Revising organisational policies and procedures
- Revising goals, objectives and targets
- Recommending changes in strategic directions for the organisation.

Identify types of recommendations

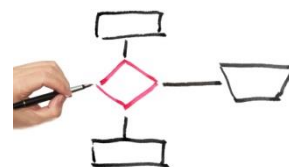
The following are often included among the recommendations following the review and evaluation process:

Suggestions as to what to do to leverage on identified strengths

- Plans for same – timelines, actions, proposed responsibility, KPIs for implementation
- Cost or resources required
- Benefits flowing as a result – including when these are expected to occur
- Recommendations for extending identified strengths or transferring them to other properties or departments
- Exploiting a deficiency or weakness in competition in the marketplace.

Recommendation to address identified weaknesses

- Identification of weaknesses which should be addressed
- Explanation of why 'other' weaknesses should be ignored
- Plans for addressing them – see above plus action to limit further/future negative outcomes
- Cost and resources required.



Strategies for addressing identified opportunities and threats

- Costed options for action – including identification of any external funding which may be available
- Plans for same.

Recommendations for capitalising on golden opportunities

These are opportunities which:

- You have a realistic chance of achieving
- Are unlikely to present again



Recommendation, as identified/supported by the evidence, for introducing, modifying or removing:

- Certain internal processes – operational, reporting, SOPs
- Identified personnel – through training, adding or reducing staff/hours
- Nominated systems or technology.

Recommendations for changing the organisational structure of the business

- Revising the organisational structure
- Re-writing job descriptions and job specifications
- Revising the public statements for the business
- Reviewing team structures or composition.



Recommendations for:

- Re-design of the management framework
- Revisions to the business model of the organisation.

Recommendations to enable greater compliance with:

- Legislated obligations
- Company policies and procedures
- Expectations of key stakeholders.

Recommendations to address future activity in relation to areas

- Identified hazards and risks
- Delivery of service and products to a set standard/criteria
- Specific problems faced by the business when the situational analysis was undertaken or which, in fact, may have given rise to the need for a situational analysis in the first instance. These may relate to certain aspects/departments of the business. For example:
 - Staff training
 - Low levels of traffic, bookings or custom
 - Stock control
 - Pricing
 - Staffing
 - Communication – internally and externally.

Inclusions in a recommendation

Now that we have identified a wide variety of recommendations that can be made, it is now time to put them into the appropriate format for presentation to appropriate stakeholders.

In general terms, the more costly the recommendation, in terms of funding and other resources, the greater the need for a more formal style of recommendation such as providing a proposal that:

- Detail the problem that is at the root of the recommendation
- Highlights any legal compliance requirements that may be included
- Describes the negative impacts of the above situation – which may include, for example, the need to lay off staff, the need to increase prices, the eventual result if the current situation is allowed to continue for 12 months
- Identifies specific revised targets – which should reflect the initial targets set by the business and operational plans that are facing difficulty such as (as appropriate) income, expenditure, percentages, items sold, etc.
- Sets revised flags to warn of unacceptable deviations to the revised targets – this will help identify revised circumstances when actual performance has deviated unacceptably from revised budgeted or figures
- Presents options for rectifying the position – it is always useful to present more than one possible solution wherever possible
- Sets out implementation costs for each recommendation or option
- Identifies the benefits of each recommendation or proposal
- Supplies a formal cost-benefit analysis
- Gives realistic timelines for introduction and implementation.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

3.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 25

3.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 26

3.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 27,28

3.4 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 24
-

Summary

Finalise the innovative tourism program/project

Administer winding up activities for the program/project

- Types of project/program finalisation activities

Review program/project administration

- Activities associated with reviewing project/program administration
- Timing of project/program reviews

Evaluate the program/project

- Difference between reviewing and evaluating success of project / program
- Aims of evaluating success of project / program
- Evaluation activities

Report on program/project administration and results

- Explaining project performance related information
- Present recommendations for variation to project plans
- Steps associated with making recommendations
- Identify types of recommendations
- Inclusions in a recommendation

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Abranhs, Rhonda; 2014 (6th edition); *Successful Business Plan: Secrets & Strategies*; Planning Shop

Bangs, David; 2002 (9th edition); *The Business Planning Guide*; Kaplan Publishing

Blakely, Edward James & Leigh, Nancey Green; 2013 (5th edition); *Planning local economic development: theory and practice*; Los Angeles SAGE.

Bricker, Kelly S & Black, Rosemary & Cottrell, Stuart; 2013 (1st edition); *Sustainable tourism & the millennium development goals: effecting positive change*; MA Jones & Bartlett Learning.

Chambers, Erve; 2009 (2nd edition); *Native Tours: The Anthropology of Travel and Tourism*; Waveland Pr Inc

Crabtree, Alice & South West Institute of TAFE; 2000 (1st edition); *Plan and develop interpretive activities*; South West Institute of TAFE

Diaz, P; 2015, *Tourism as a tool for development*; Southampton WIT Press

Field, Gil & Western Australia Department of Conservation and Land Management; 2000 (1st edition); *Developing ecotours and other interpretive activity programs: a guidebook for planning, designing, promoting and conducting ecotourism activity programs*; Dept. of Conservation, Como

Green, Gary P & Phillips, Rhonda G; 2013; *Local food and community development*; Routledge

Guyette, Susan; 2013 (1st edition); *Sustainable Cultural Tourism: Small-Scale Solutions*; Bear Path Press

International Hospitality & Tourism Postgraduate Conference (2013: Shah Alam, Malaysia) 2015, *Hospitality and tourism: Synergising creativity and innovation in research*; Crc press

Kerzner, Harold; 2013 (11th edition); *Project Management: A Systems Approach to Planning, Scheduling, and Controlling*; Wiley

Maynard, Therese H; 2010 (1st edition); *Business Planning*; Aspen Publishers

Miller, Richard K; 2013, *Travel & tourism market research handbook: A biennial strategic planning and reference handbook*; Richard K Miller & Assoc

Morrison, Alastair M; 2013, *Marketing and managing tourism destinations*; Routledge

Patterson, Carol; 2007 (3rd edition); *The Business of Ecotourism*; Trafford Publishing

Phillips, Rhonda; 2015 (2nd edition); *An introduction to community development*; Routledge.

Rad, Parviz; 2009 (2nd edition); *Integrated Project Planning; Project Management Excellence*; Wiley

Richards, Adam; 2014 (Kindle edition); *Project Management: A Beginner's Guide to Effectively Manage Any Project like the Pros Do*; Amazon Digital Services

Schmidt, Terry; 2009 (1st edition); *Strategic Project Management Made Simple: Practical Tools for Leaders and Teams*; Wiley

Weiler, Betty; 2014 (1st edition); *Tour Guiding Research: Insights, Issues and Implications*; Channel View Publications

Trainee evaluation sheet

Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project			
1.1	Confirm the program/project	☐	☐
1.2	Identify factors affecting timelines for implementation	☐	☐
1.3	Develop program/project plans	☐	☐
1.4	Link budget to key outcomes	☐	☐
1.5	Identify monitoring and reporting arrangements	☐	☐
1.6	Allocate resources	☐	☐
1.7	Integrate program/plan with other initiatives	☐	☐
1.8	Confirm agreements with service providers	☐	☐
1.9	Develop contingency plans	☐	☐
1.10	Develop teams to support program/project implementation	☐	☐
1.11	Select program/project management tools	☐	☐
Element 2: Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project			
2.1	Allocate tasks and resources	☐	☐
2.2	Maintain financial control systems	☐	☐
2.3	Monitor program/project progress	☐	☐
2.4	Report program/project progress	☐	☐
2.5	Maintain program/project records	☐	☐
2.6	Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 3: Finalise the innovative tourism program/project			
3.1	Administer winding up activities for the program/project	☐	☐
3.2	Review program/project administration	☐	☐
3.3	Evaluate the program/project	☐	☐
3.4	Report on program/project administration and results	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

